

# Jal Jeevan Samvad

June | Volume 7 | Issue 6 | Year 2026



Har Ghar Jal  
Jal Jeevan Mission

Building Partnership  
Changing Lives

District/ Village  
Dialogues Series



Articles by Director, NJJM  
and DC/ DMs of 6 districts

The first part of the paper discusses the importance of the research and the objectives of the study. It highlights the need for a comprehensive understanding of the subject matter and the role of the researcher in this process. The second part of the paper presents the methodology used in the study, including the data collection methods and the analysis techniques. The third part of the paper discusses the results of the study and the conclusions drawn from the findings. The final part of the paper provides a summary of the key points and offers suggestions for future research.

The research was conducted in a systematic and rigorous manner, following the principles of scientific inquiry. The data was collected from a representative sample of the population, and the analysis was performed using advanced statistical techniques. The results of the study indicate that there is a significant relationship between the variables under investigation, and this finding has important implications for the field of study.

In conclusion, the study has provided valuable insights into the subject matter and has contributed to the existing body of knowledge. The findings suggest that further research is needed to explore the underlying mechanisms and to test the generalizability of the results. The researcher hopes that this work will inspire others to continue the exploration of this important topic.

# Contents



## Minister of Jal Shakti on Jal Jeevan Mission .....1

## Minister of States, Jal Shakti on Jal Jeevan Mission.....2

## Foreword by the Secretary, DDWS .....3

## Note from the desk of Additional Secretary & Mission Director.....4

### JJM Program

Progressive coverage-Functional Household Tap Connection (FHTC).....5

Comparative FHTC coverage status of States/ UTs.....6

### Articles

Reform Linked MoUs signed with 7 States & 1 UT under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 in June 2026  
- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU-NJJM.....7

From Innovation to Impact: DDWS Backs Grassroots Technologies for Safe Drinking Water and Plastic Waste Solutions in Rural India  
- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU- NJJM.....18

Sujal Gram Samvad Strengthens Community-Led Water Governance: Five Gram Panchayats Share Rural Water Success Stories in 8<sup>th</sup> Edition  
- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU-NJJM.....23

DDWS Organises 9th District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad to Accelerate JJM 2.0 Implementation and Strengthen Service Delivery  
- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU-NJJM.....33

16<sup>th</sup> Finance Commission Grant to RLBs: Strengthening Rural Water and Sanitation Service Delivery  
- Yogendra Kumar Singh, Director, NJJM, - DDWS .....40

Yamunanagar Achieves 100% Household Tap Connections: A Model for Sustainable Rural Water Supply  
- Preeti, Deputy Commissioner, Yamunanagar.....43

Transforming Rural Water Security in Sepahijala: From Har Ghar Jal to Har Din Jal  
- Dr. Siddharth Shiv Jaiswal, DM & DC Sepahijala District, Tripura.....47

Sivasagar: Redefining Sustainability of Rural Water Supply  
- Mridul Yadav, Deputy Commissioner, Sivasagar, Assam.....51

Jal Jeevan Mission in Ayodhya –From Access to Assured Har Ghar Jal  
- Shashank Tripathi, DM Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh.....55

Redefining Sustainability of Rural Drinking Water Supply in Una  
- Jatin Lal, IAS, Deputy Commissioner, Una, Himachal Pradesh.....63

Transforming Rural Water Supply: The Jal Jeevan Mission's Success Story in Dras Sector, Kargil, UT Ladakh  
- Rakesh Kumar, DC, Kargil, Ladakh.....72

Opinion Article by Secretary, DDWS.75

DDWS Participated in the 12<sup>th</sup> International Yoga Day.....75

Monthly review meeting .....78

Visit of Shri C.R. Patil, Minister of Jal Shakti to West Bengal.....81

Jal Jeevan Mission in Media.....92

**Editor:** Yogendra Kumar Singh, Director, NJJM

**Editorial Team:** Chanchal Kumar Modi, Lopamudra Panda, Amit Kumar Ranjan, Arpan De Sarkar

**Design:** Kamna Dubey

**Edition:** 69<sup>th</sup> (June 2026)

**Publisher:** Arun Kumar, Under Secretary (DDWS)  
National Jal Jeevan Mission, Ministry of Jal Shakti, New Delhi - 110 003  
E-mail: rnd-ddws@gov.in

*Reproduction in any form is prohibited without written permission. Any dispute related to the content of the magazine should be addressed to the publisher.*

# Minister of Jal Shakti on Jal Jeevan Mission

“



**C R Patil**

Union Minister of Jal Shakti

जल जीवन मिशन : बदलाव की ओर एक ऐतिहासिक कदम प्रधानमंत्री श्री *Narendra Modi* सर के नेतृत्व में जल जीवन मिशन ने ग्रामीण भारत के करोड़ों परिवारों के जीवन में सकारात्मक परिवर्तन का मार्ग प्रशस्त किया है। वर्ष 2019 में शुरू हुई इस महत्वाकांक्षी पहल के माध्यम से आज 12.60 करोड़ से अधिक ग्रामीण परिवारों तक नल से स्वच्छ जल की सुविधा पहुंचाई जा चुकी है। यह केवल जल आपूर्ति की योजना नहीं, बल्कि महिलाओं के सम्मान, बेहतर स्वास्थ्य, समय की बचत और जीवन की गुणवत्ता में सुधार का एक व्यापक अभियान है।

जिन घरों में कभी पानी के लिए लंबी दूरी तय करनी पड़ती थी, वहां आज नल से जल पहुंच रहा है। अंत्योदय की भावना और जनभागीदारी के संकल्प के साथ केंद्र सरकार ने यह सुनिश्चित किया है कि विकास का लाभ समाज के अंतिम व्यक्ति तक पहुंचे। जल जीवन मिशन, विकसित भारत के निर्माण की दिशा में एक महत्वपूर्ण आधारशिला बनकर उभरा है और ग्रामीण भारत को आत्मविश्वास, सुविधा तथा नई संभावनाओं से जोड़ रहा है। “हर घर तक जल, हर परिवार तक सम्मान” यह नए भारत की पहचान है।

- Hon'ble Union Minister, Jal Shakti (X handle)

8<sup>th</sup> June, 2026

”

# Minister of State, Jal Shakti on Jal Jeevan Mission

“



**V. Somanna**

Minister of States for Jal Shakti

*A key pillar of Jal Jeevan Mission is community-led water management. Across rural India, trained Nal Jal Mitras are playing a vital role in the operation, maintenance, and repair of village water supply infrastructure, ensuring sustainable and reliable tap water services at the grassroots.*

*By building local technical capacity and strengthening community ownership, Nal Jal Mitras are helping secure the long-term success of the Mission while empowering villages to manage their own water resources effectively.*

- Remarks mentioned on social media (X handle)

5<sup>th</sup> June, 2026

”





## Foreword



**A**s the country moves through the first half of 2026, Jal Jeevan Mission has entered an important phase of transition. The focus is increasingly on strengthening the systems, institutions, and partnerships required to sustain the gains achieved so far. Recent developments reflect a growing emphasis on service quality, innovation, evidence-based planning, and community-centred delivery, critical for ensuring reliable and resilient rural drinking water systems over the long term.

While significant progress has been made in providing access to drinking water, sustaining safe and regular water supply to every rural household requires continued attention to water quality surveillance, laboratory networks, community-based testing, and timely corrective action. The increasing use of technology, monitoring systems, and citizen participation in water quality management demonstrates a broader shift toward improved service outcomes and greater public confidence.

A major milestone during June was the completion of reform-linked Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) with all remaining States and UTs. With the nationwide MoU framework now in place, a strong foundation has been established for advancing the reform agenda and long-term objectives of JJM 2.0. The month continuous the dialogue series and witnessed the 9th District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad and the 8th Sujal Gram Samvad.

A significant event during the month was the Grand Finale of the DDWS Innovation Challenge, which showcased innovative solutions to key challenges in the drinking water and sanitation sector. The event reinforced the importance of encouraging startups, researchers, academic institutions, and technology partners to develop scalable solutions that improve governance, monitoring, service delivery, and sustainability.

A major highlight of June was DDWS participation in the National Workshop on R&D in Water, which underscored the importance of research-driven solutions, climate resilience, and stronger collaboration among government, academia, startups, and industry. In this context, the recent collaboration with ISRO marks an important step toward data-driven decision-making and improved source sustainability planning through geospatial technologies.

These developments reflect an evolving phase-JJM 2.0, one that places equal emphasis on sustainability, innovation, institutional strengthening, and service quality. Through continued collaboration and community engagement through Gram Panchayats, we remain committed to realizing the vision of Har Ghar Jal as a lasting reality for every rural household.

**Ashok K. K. Meena**  
Secretary,

Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation



## Note from the desk of Additional Secretary & Mission Director...



**A**s Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 gains momentum, our focus is increasingly on ensuring reliable service delivery, strengthening community ownership, and securing long-term water sustainability.

A significant milestone during the month was the completion of reform-linked MoUs with the remaining State/UTs. With this achievement, all State/UTs are now aligned under the framework of JJM 2.0, reaffirming a shared commitment towards regular, safe, and sustainable drinking water services.

The month also witnessed the successful organisation of 9th District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad and 8th Sujal Gram Samvad. These platforms continue to provide valuable opportunities for exchange of experiences and field-level learning. Discussions highlighted the importance of strengthening service reliability, enhancing monitoring systems, addressing last-mile challenges, and promoting community ownership. Inputs from District Collectors, Gram Panchayats, Village Water & Sanitation Committees, and community representatives once again demonstrated that sustainable outcomes can be achieved only through strong partnerships between institutions and citizens.

One of the highlight of the month was the Grand Finale of the National Innovation Challenge, organised in collaboration with IIT Madras. The event showcased innovative solutions and fresh ideas from researchers, start-ups, and innovators addressing challenges in rural water supply and water management. Such initiatives strengthen the innovation ecosystem around the Mission and encourage the adoption of practical, technology-enabled, and community-centric solutions to improve service delivery.

Field visits across Odisha, Chhattisgarh, Uttar Pradesh, and Madhya Pradesh provided valuable insights into implementation on the ground. Interactions with beneficiaries, women involved in water quality monitoring, Jal Bahinis, Gram Panchayats, and Water Committees highlighted the transformative impact of assured tap water supply on rural communities. Participation in Jal Arpan programmes further reinforced the importance of community ownership and local stewardship of water supply assets. The visits also underscored the need for continued focus on source sustainability, water quality surveillance, rainwater harvesting, and strengthening operation and maintenance systems to ensure lasting outcomes.

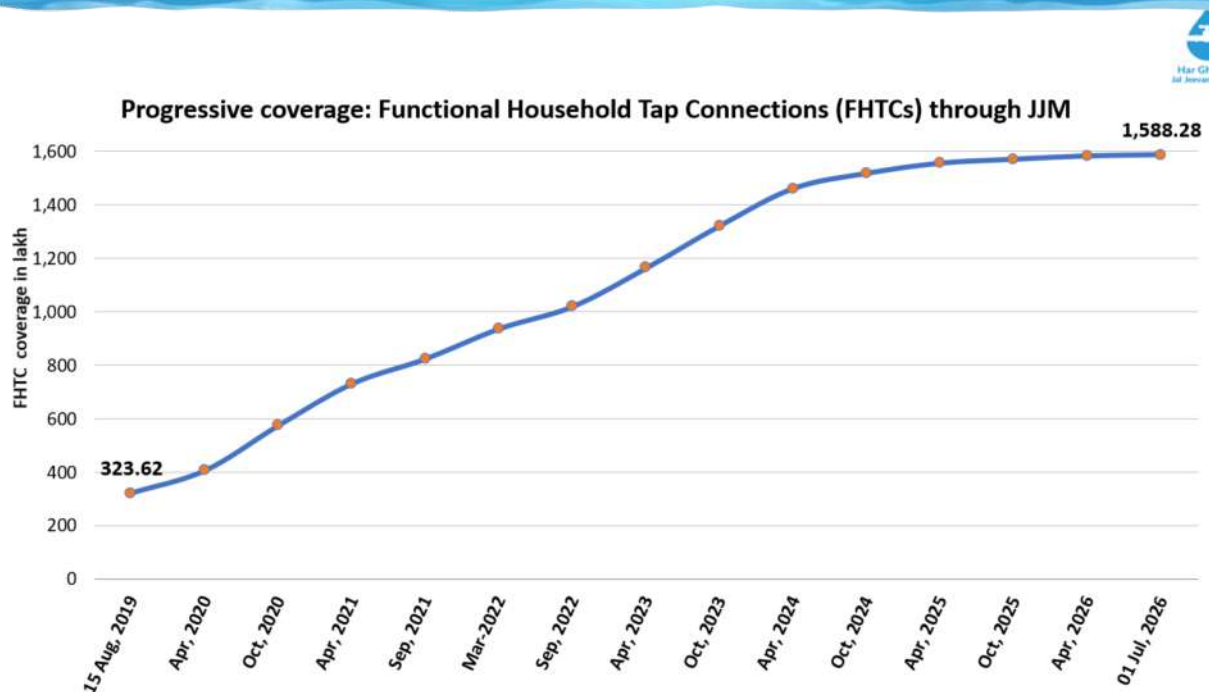
As the Mission progresses, success will increasingly be measured not only by access to tap water but by the quality, reliability, and sustainability of services delivered every day. Strengthening Gram Panchayat-led systems, deepening Jan Bhagidari, promoting innovation, and ensuring responsible management of water resources will remain central to the Mission's journey towards providing lasting drinking water security for rural India.

Kamal Kishore Soan  
Additional Secretary & Mission Director (NJJM)  
Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation

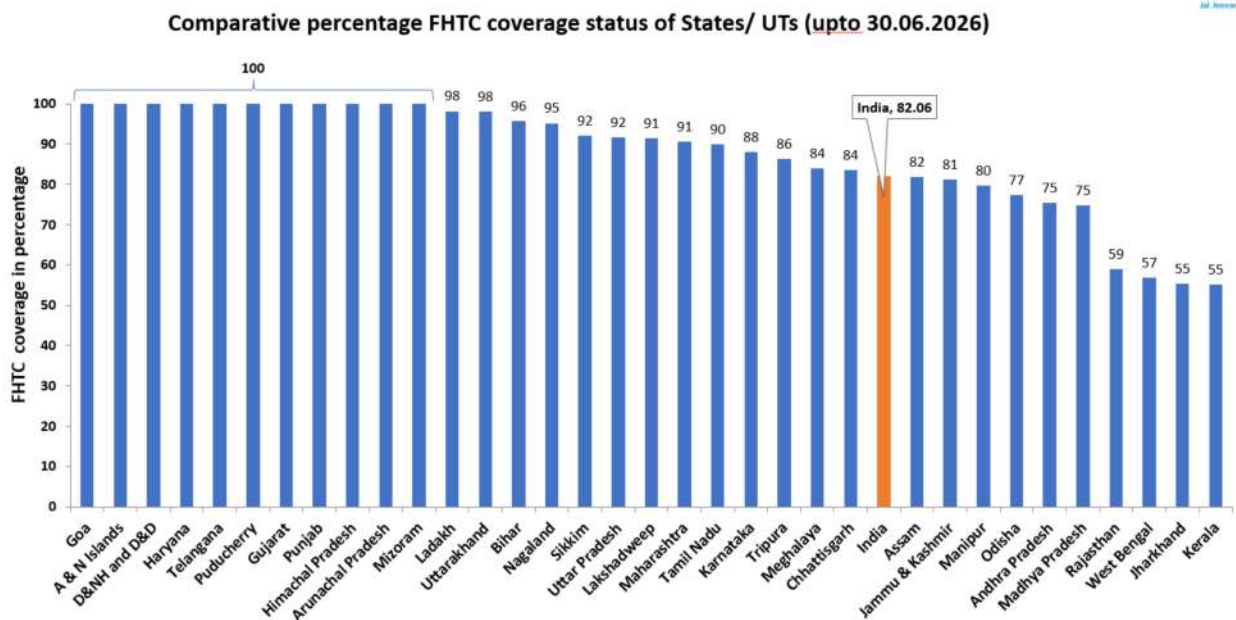




## Progressive coverage - Functional Household Tap Connection (FHTC) (as on 30.06.2026)



## Comparative FHTC coverage status of States/ UTs (as on 30.06.2026)





# As on 30<sup>th</sup> June 2026

Source: JIM-IMIS

## India | Status of tap water supply in rural homes

|                                                                           |                                                         |                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Total number of households (HHs)                                          | Households with tap water connections as on 15 Aug 2019 | Remaining households |
| <b>19,35,60,387</b>                                                       | <b>3,23,62,838</b><br>(16.72%)                          | <b>16,11,97,549</b>  |
| Households provided with tap water connection since launch of the Mission | Households with tap water connections as on date +9,738 |                      |
| <b>12,64,65,507</b> (78.45%)                                              | <b>15,88,28,345</b> ( 82.06% )                          |                      |

### Har Ghar Jal Status ⓘ

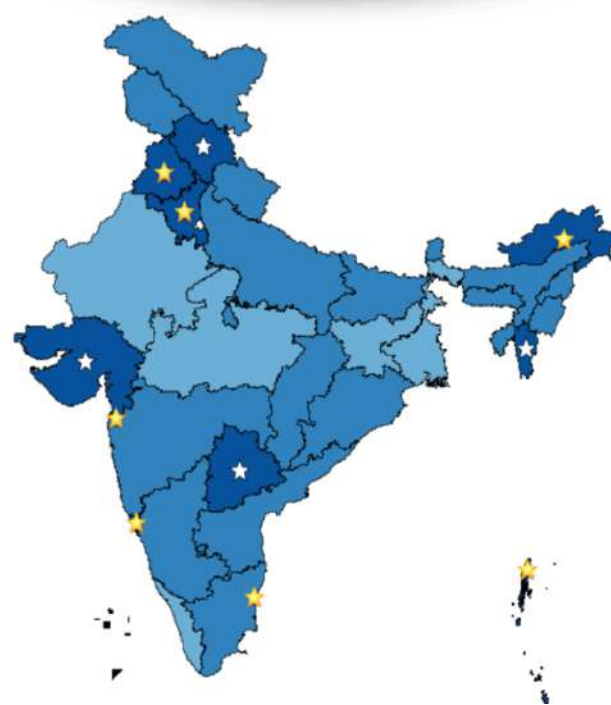
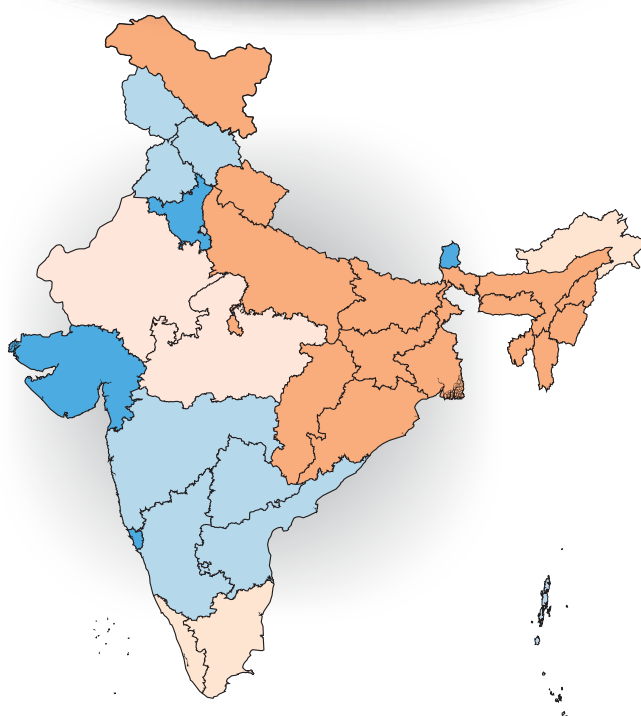
Certified States/ UTs : Goa, A & N Islands, Puducherry, D&NH and D&D, Arunachal Pradesh, Haryana, Punjab

Reported States/ UTs : Telangana, Mizoram, Himachal Pradesh, Gujarat

| Districts  |             | Blocks     |             | Panchayats     |               | Villages        |                 |
|------------|-------------|------------|-------------|----------------|---------------|-----------------|-----------------|
| Reported ⓘ | Certified ⓘ | Reported ⓘ | Certified ⓘ | Reported ⓘ     | Certified ⓘ   | Reported ⓘ      | Certified ⓘ     |
| 192        | 119         | 1,937      | 1,056 (+1)  | 1,31,901 (+39) | 95,692 (+107) | 2,84,214 (+187) | 1,90,746 (+200) |

As on 15<sup>th</sup> August, 2019

As on 30<sup>th</sup> June, 2026



0%-10%

11%-25%

26%-50%

51%-75%

76%-<100%

100%



## Reform Linked MoUs signed with 7 States & 1 UT under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 in June 2026

- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU-NJJM

In June, reform-linked Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0 were signed with seven states, Arunachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Nagaland, Sikkim, Manipur, and Bihar, and one UT, Puducherry. This marks a remarkable step towards sustainable, assured, and citizen-centric rural drinking water supply across India.

The reform linked MoU mandates a Gram Panchayat led, service based and community centred model of

rural water governance, aligned with the objectives of Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 and seeks to ensure that every rural household has access to drinking water supply in adequate quantity and of prescribed quality on a regular basis, through strengthened community participation (Jan Bhagidari) and bringing in structural reforms for sustainable operation and maintenance of rural water supply systems, thereby enhancing the living standards of rural communities contributing to long term water security aligned with the national

vision of Viksit Bharat @2047.

The first phase of MoU signings during June was held on 2nd June, with five States/UTs (Arunachal Pradesh, Jharkhand, Tamil Nadu, Nagaland and Puducherry) through separate scheduled meetings conducted via video conferencing. These MoUs were signed in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C.R. Patil, and Minister of State, Shri V. Somanna, along with the Chief Ministers and senior officials of the respective States/UTs. Senior



Figure :1 | Exchange of MoUs on 2nd June in the presence of Hon'ble MoJS & MoS | Source: NJJM



Figure :2 | Exchange of MoU with Arunachal Pradesh | Source: NJJM

officials from the Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS), including Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Secretary, DDWS, and Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary & Mission Director, National Jal Jeevan Mission (NJJM), also participated in the proceedings.

The MoU with **Arunachal Pradesh** was signed in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Patil. The Chief Minister of Arunachal Pradesh, Shri Pema Khandu, and

Minister-PHE & WS, Shri Mama Natung, also joined the event virtually, along with senior officials from Government of Arunachal Pradesh. The MoUs was signed and exchanged by Smt. Swati Meena Naik, Joint Secretary (Water), DDWS, and Shri Amjad Tak, Commissioner, PHE and WSD, Government of Arunachal Pradesh.

Marking a pivotal moment in Centre-State collaboration, the MoU with State of Jharkhand was formally

signed after Arunachal Pradesh. The meeting commenced in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Patil, Jharkhand Chief Minister Shri Hemant Soren, and other key officials from the State, who all joined virtually through video conferencing, Shri Yogendra Prasad, Minister, Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation, Jharkhand was physically present during the meeting with mission officials. The MoU was signed and exchanged by Smt. Swati Meena Naik, Joint Secretary (Water), DDWS, and Shri Abu Imran, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation, Government of Jharkhand.



Figure :3 | Exchange of MoU with Jharkhand | Source: NJJM

For the State of **Tamil Nadu** the MoU signing took place under the presence of Union Minister Shri C. R. Patil, Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, Thiru. C. Joseph Vijay, and other officials from State who joined through VC. The MoU was signed by D Senthil Pandiyan, Joint Secretary, NJJM and Thiru. Gagandeep Singh Bedi, Additional Chief Secretary, Municipal Administration and Water Supply Department, Govt of Tamil Nadu and was exchanged by Tmt. R. Jaya, Chief Resident Commissioner.





Figure :4 | Exchange of MoU with Tamil Nadu | Source: NJJM

The MoU with UT of **Puducherry** was signed between Smt. Swati Meena Naik, Joint Secretary (Water), DDWS, Ministry of Jal Shakti, and Dr. A. Muthamma, Commissioner-cum-

Secretary, PWD -Puducherry and exchanged by Shri Ravi Deep Singh Chahar, Joint Resident Commissioner-Puducherry in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C.R.

Patil, and virtual presence of Chief Minister of Puducherry, Shri N. Rangasamy, and other senior officials from the UT.



Figure :5 | Exchange of MoU with Puducherry | Source: NJJM



Figure :6 | Exchange of MoU with Nagaland | Source: NJJM

The fifth MoU of the day was held with the State of **Nagaland** in the presence of Chief Minister of Nagaland, Shri Neiphiu Rio who joined through VC along with PHED Minister of Nagaland, Shri Jacob Zhimomi and other senior officials from the State.

The MoU was signed by Smt. Swati Meena Naik, Joint Secretary (Water), DDWS, and Shri Zarenthung Ezung, Secretary & Mission Director (JJM) Nagaland and was exchanged by Smt.

Sharon Longchari, Joint Resident Commissioner, Nagaland House.

Addressing the gathering, **Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Patil** said that Jal Jeevan Mission, launched under the leadership of Hon'ble Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, has transformed rural drinking water supply across the country and reduced the ordeal of fetching water especially by women and girls. Under JJM 2.0, now the focus is on sustaining the infrastructures created under

the Mission, functionality of tap connections, water quality, source sustainability, O&M, community ownership and regular monitoring as key priorities.

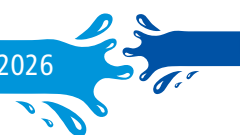
The Minister also stressed the need for water conservation, rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge, greywater management, catchment area protection and community-based water quality monitoring. He said Gram Panchayats, District Water and Sanitation Missions, State Water and Sanitation Missions and local communities must work together to ensure reliable drinking water services.

Under his addressal to the State of Arunachal Pradesh, Shri Patil said considering the state's mountainous terrain and heavy rainfall, the O&M policy to be notified soon. He also stressed holding regular meetings of DWSMs, accelerating NABL accreditation of laboratories, and conducting 'Jal Arpan Diwas' to formally handover of assets to the GPs.

To the state of Jharkhand, the Union Minister asked to ensure proper



Figure :7 | Address by Hon'ble MoJS during MoU signings | Source: NJJM



O&M, source sustainability, and water conservation. Appreciating the State's progress, he urged faster completion of ongoing works so remaining rural households receive safe drinking water and expressed confidence that coordinated efforts will help Jharkhand achieve JJM 2.0 goals.

While addressing to Tamil Nadu, Shri Patil commended the states progress under JJM expressed confidence that the state will complete remaining work soon. He urged to focus on community-level rainwater harvesting, source sustainability, water conservation, and greywater management, by effectively using the Finance Commission grants and VB-G RAM G funds.

Shri C.R Patil commended Puducherry for achieving 'Har Ghar Jal' certification in the year 2021. He said the focus should now be on regular, reliable and sustainable water services, public awareness, community ownership, Gram Panchayat-level service delivery, Sujal Gaon ID creation and notification of the revised O&M policy.

Addressing Nagaland, Shri Patil expressed confidence that the State will provide tap connections to the remaining households this year, ensuring that community particularly women and children continue to benefit from safe and reliable drinking water.

**Chief Minister of Arunachal Pradesh, Shri Pema Khandu**, in his address said, Jal Jeevan Mission has significantly transformed rural drinking water supply in Arunachal Pradesh, a State with difficult terrain, scattered habitations and remote locations. He said under the Mission the state is progressing towards achieving universal household tap water coverage.

The Chief Minister said the MoU under JJM 2.0 will further strengthen water security and improve the sustainability and reliability of rural drinking water supply systems. He also highlighted the State's effort 'Jal Sankalp' for gap funding to strengthen source sustainability including the Arunachal Pradesh Spring Rejuvenation Programme.

He said catchment area protection is critical for Arunachal Pradesh, where most landholdings are community-based. Through the 'Arunachal Pradesh Protection and Management of Drinking Water Catchment Areas Act', the State Government is taking proactive steps to protect drinking water sources and catchment areas with community participation and institutional support.

He reaffirmed the State's commitment to the Mission, and added that the State Water and Sanitation Mission, State Nodal Officers and concerned departments are working proactively to ensure effective implementation and long-term sustainability of rural drinking water systems.

**In his address, Shri Hemant Soren, Chief Minister of Jharkhand** highlighted Jharkhand's commitment to provide safe and reliable drinking water to every rural household under Jal Jeevan Mission. He said the MoU will further strengthen efforts to expand functional tap water connections, especially in remote and rural areas.



Figure :8 | Address by Chief Minister, Arunachal Pradesh | Source: NJJM



Figure :9 | Address by Chief Minister, Jharkhand | Source: NJJM

He noted that Jharkhand faces challenges due to difficult terrain, laying pipelines through forest areas, NHAI, DVC working areas required NoCs. He requested continued support from the Government of India for timely completion of ongoing rural water supply schemes.

He emphasized regular monitoring, accountability and corrective action to improve implementation. Highlighting community participation, he said community-based groups and Jal Sahiyas are playing an important role in the operation, monitoring and maintenance of rural

water supply systems. They have also been trained to register and address grievances through the online grievance redressal system.

**Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, Thiru. C. Joseph Vijay**, in his address congratulated the Government of India and the Ministry of Jal Shakti for extending the implementation period of Jal Jeevan Mission up to December 2028.

He highlighted that Tamil Nadu faces unique water resource challenges, as the State does not have any major perennial source of water. Conse-

quently, ensuring reliable drinking water supply requires the implementation of large-scale and multi-village water supply schemes, supported by long-term planning and substantial investments in water infrastructure.

Referring to ongoing initiatives, he stressed the importance of expediting the already sanctioned Kavery-based water supply schemes, benefiting water-stressed districts such as Dharmapuri and Krishnagiri. These projects are critical for ensuring dependable and safe drinking water access to rural communities.



Figure :10 | Address by Chief Minister, Tamil Nadu | Source: NJJM

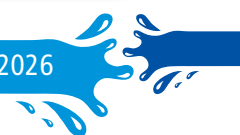




Figure :11 | Address by Chief Minister, Puducherry | Source: NJJM

He emphasized that central assistance would help strengthen its rural water supply infrastructure and ensure that every rural household receives safe and adequate drinking water on a sustained basis. He reiterated the State Government's commitment to the objectives of the Mission and expressed confidence that continued cooperation between the Centre and the State would further strengthen rural drinking water service delivery in the State.

**Chief Minister of Puducherry, Shri N. Rangasamy,** conveyed his sincere appreciation to the Hon'ble Prime Minister and the Ministry of Jal Shakti for conceptualizing and successfully implementing Jal Jeevan Mission, describing it as one of the most significant public welfare initiatives. He noted that the Mission has transformed the delivery of drinking water services by placing dignity, health, and quality of life at the core of rural development. In Puducherry, the Local Administration Department

is committed to the objectives of Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0 and expresses readiness to collaborate closely with the Ministry of Jal Shakti. He underscored key priorities including source sustainability, adoption of digital systems for water quality monitoring and grievance redressal, promotion of community-owned and managed water supply systems, and sustainable water resource management, aligning with the Mission's holistic approach.



Figure :12 | Address by Chief Minister, Nagaland | Source: NJJM

In his address, **Shri Neiphiu Rio, Chief Minister of Nagaland**, expressed sincere gratitude to the Government of India, Ministry of Jal Shakti, and DDWS for their steadfast support and described JJM as one of the most transformative rural development initiatives in recent years. He noted that the Mission has significantly improved the quality of life by bringing safe drinking water directly to households.

Reflecting on the State's unique geographical challenges, he highlighted that providing reliable water supply in hilly, dispersed rural areas had long been difficult, with many families earlier depending on distant springs and traditional sources. In this context, JJM has marked a transformation by reducing daily hardships especially for women and children and ensuring safer, more accessible water for rural communities.

Welcoming the vision of Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0, he reaffirmed the State's commitment to its reform-driven, whole-of-government approach, which promotes institutional strengthening, community ownership, and sustainable water management.

Subsequently, the MoU with **Sikkim** was signed on 9<sup>th</sup> June, in the presence of Union Minister Shri C.R. Patil and Chief Minister Shri Prem Singh Tamang, Shri Ashwini Kumar Chand, ADGP cum Pr. Resident Commissioner, Govt. of Sikkim, along with Shri. Anil Raj Rai, Secretary, RDD, Government of Sikkim.

The MoUs was exchanged between Shri D Senthil Pandiyan, Joint Secretary, NJJM, and Shri Ashwini Kumar Chand, ADGP cum Pr. Resident Commissioner, Govt. of Sikkim.

Addressing the gathering, **Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Patil**



Figure :13 | Signing of MoU with Sikkim | Source: NJJM



Figure :14 | Exchange of MoU with Sikkim | Source: NJJM



Figure :15 | Address by Chief Minister, Sikkim | Source: NJJM



appreciated the State for the progress achieved under JJM and emphasized strengthening district-level planning through the preparation of District Improvement Plans based on Gram Panchayat-level water service assessments. He said that these plans should help identify service gaps, improve scheme performance, strengthen monitoring and ensure better service delivery at the district level.

The Minister urged the State to notify O&M policy by including all 19 essential points for sustainable service delivery and also requested to complete Sujal Gram ID and Sujalam Bharat ID creation in a time-bound manner.

He added that the State should continue to work within the approved guidelines and existing framework of the mission, with a focus on sustainable, community-owned and reliable water supply services across rural habitations.

In his address, **Shri Prem Singh Tamang, Chief Minister of Sikkim** expressed gratitude to the Ministry of Jal Shakti for its continued support under Jal Jeevan Mission and highlighted the transformative

impact of the Mission in a geographically challenging, disaster-prone Himalayan state like Sikkim. Referring to the vision of Prime Minister for ensuring safe drinking water in every rural household, he noted that the Mission has significantly improved the quality of life of rural communities across the State.

He stated that Sikkim has remained committed to the objectives of JJM since its inception and has achieved coverage despite difficult terrain, dispersed habitations and high infrastructure development costs. The State undertook extensive upgradation, expansion and modernization of rural water supply infrastructure in accordance with the Mission guidelines issued in 2019.

Reaffirming the State Government's commitment to sustaining these gains, the Chief Minister emphasized the importance of strengthening rural water supply systems and ensuring long-term service delivery. He reiterated Sikkim's commitment to working closely with the Government of India to realize the shared goal of providing safe, reliable and sustainable drinking water services to every rural household.

He further highlighted State's commitment to sustainable source sustainability measures under CAMPA project and VB-G RAM G. He said the MoU will further strengthen efforts to expand functional tap water connections, especially in remote and rural areas.

In the third phase, MoUs were signed with **Manipur and Bihar** during separate meetings held on 10th June. The MoUs with Manipur was signed in the presence of the Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C.R. Patil, and Chief Minister of Manipur, Shri Yumnam Khemchand Singh and for Bihar MoU was done in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C.R. Patil, and Minister of State, Dr. Raj Bhushan Choudhary and Shri Sanjay Kumar Singh, Minister (PHE) Bihar, during separate scheduled meetings

**For Manipur**, MoU was exchanged between D Senthil Pandian, Joint Secretary, NJJM, and Dr Neilinhang Teilien, Secretary to Chief Minister, Manipur in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Patil, Chief Minister of Manipur, Shri Yumnam Khemchand Singh, and Deputy Chief Minister (PHED), Manipur, Shri Losii Dikho.



Figure :16 | Signing of MoU with Manipur and Bihar | Source: NJJM

Marking a pivotal moment in Centre-State collaboration, the MoU with State of **Bihar** was formally signed after Manipur. The meeting commenced in the presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Patil, Dr. Raj Bhusan Choudhary, Minister of State, Shri Sanjay Kumar Singh, Minister (PHE) Bihar and other key officials from the State & DDWS.

The MoU was signed and exchanged by Shri D Senthil Pandian, Joint Secretary, NJJM, and Shri Rajesh Kumar, Principal Secretary, PHE Department, Bihar.

**Union Minister of Jal Shakti, Shri C. R. Patil** stressed the need for water conservation, rainwater harvesting, groundwater recharge, catchment area protection using Finance Commission and VB-GRAM G funds. He stressed community-based water quality monitoring and said Gram Panchayats, District Water and Sanitation Missions, State Water and Sanitation Missions and local communities must work together to ensure reliable drinking water services. He reiterated the Government of India's continued support to the State in achieving the Mission's objectives.

Addressing Manipur, he expressed confidence that the state would soon complete the remaining tap connections and join the group of States and Union Territories that have achieved universal rural tap water coverage. Appreciating the resilience shown by the State in continuing implementation despite difficult conditions, Shri Patil remarked that Manipur's achievements would serve as an inspiring example of commitment to ensuring safe drinking water for every rural household.

To the state of Bihar, the Union Minister asked to ensure proper O&M, and said he is confident that Bihar will complete the remaining



Figure :17 | Exchange of MoU with Bihar | Source: NJJM

work with the same commitment and determination that has enabled it to achieve over 90 per cent coverage. The State's contribution will be important in realizing the vision of Viksit Bharat-Viksit Bihar and ensuring improved quality of life for millions of citizens.

Speaking on the occasion, the **Chief Minister of Manipur, Shri Yumnam Khemchand Singh** said, it was a privilege to witness the signing of the Reform-Linked Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) between the Ministry of Jal Shakti and the

Government of Manipur under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0. He noted that the next phase of the Mission represents a strategic shift from a primary focus on infrastructure creation to ensuring long-term, sustainable drinking water service delivery.

He highlighted that JJM 2.0 places emphasis on service delivery, source sustainability, digital monitoring frameworks, policy reforms, sustainable funding mechanisms, and community participation. These measures, he said, would help



Figure :18 | Address by Chief Minister, Manipur | Source: NJJM

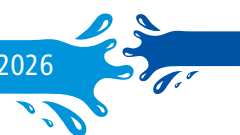




Figure :19 | Address by PHED Minister, Bihar | Source: NJJM

transform the Mission from a government programme into a people-centric movement aimed at securing safe and reliable drinking water services for rural communities.

He appreciated the efforts of the Ministry of Jal Shakti in formulating the guidelines for JJM 2.0 and reiterated the State Government's full commitment to implementing the reform agenda and achieving the Mission's objectives for improving the quality of life and ensuring sustainable water security for all.

In his address, Shri Sanjay Kumar Singh, Minister PHE Department of Bihar, said that Bihar has remained firmly committed to ensuring safe and adequate drinking water for every rural household. Even before the launch of the Jal Jeevan Mission, the State Government initiated the ambitious 'Har Ghar Nal Ka Jal' programme in 2016.

Under this initiative, an extensive rural water supply network has been developed. However Central

assistance has helped a lot in achieving significant strides in expanding rural drinking water infrastructure and improving service delivery despite numerous geographical and socio-economic challenges in the state.

He assured that Bihar remains committed to working closely with the Government of India to achieve the shared goal of safe and sustainable drinking water for all.



## From Innovation to Impact: DDWS Backs Grassroots Technologies for Safe Drinking Water and Plastic Waste Solutions in Rural India

- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU-NJJM

The Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), under the Ministry of Jal Shakti, organised the **Grand Finale** of the **DDWS Innovation Challenge** in New Delhi on 30<sup>th</sup> June. The meeting brings together policymakers, researchers, start-ups and innovators to showcase practical solutions for two critical rural development priorities i.e safe drinking water and plastic waste management.

The event was held in the august presence of Union Minister of Jal Shakti Shri C.R. Patil, Union Minister

of State for Jal Shakti and Railways Shri V. Somanna, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Additional Secretary and Mission Director, National Jal Jeevan Mission Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, and Joint Secretary and Mission Director, Swachh Bharat Mission (Grameen) Ms Aishwarya Singh. Senior officials of DDWS, representatives from IIT Madras, jury members, start-ups and innovators also attended the event.

Organised in collaboration with IIT Madras, the DDWS Innovation

Challenge sought to identify practical, scalable and affordable technologies that could strengthen the implementation of flagship programmes such as the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) and the Swachh Bharat Mission - Grameen (SBM-G). While one track focused on developing portable and reliable water quality testing technologies for rural areas, the other aimed at identifying small-scale, cost-effective and sustainable solutions for plastic waste management.

The challenge received an encourag-



Figure :20 | Grand Finale - DDWS Innovation Challenge, chaired by MoJS and Co-chair by MoS | Source: NJJM



**Total Application – 348**

**Counted entries for Challenge**

- Water Innovation Challenge – 90
- Plastic Waste Management Challenge – 66

**3 innovative technologies under each category selected by the committee**

ing response from innovators across the country. A total of 348 applications were registered on the portal. Among these, 90 applications under the Water Innovation Challenge and 66 applications under the Plastic Waste Management Challenge were found complete in all respects and taken forward for detailed evaluation.

Following a rigorous assessment process, six innovative technologies (three under each category) were shortlisted by a selection committee chaired by Prof. Ligy Philip of IIT Madras and presented during the Grand Finale.

Addressing the gathering, Union Minister Shri C.R. Patil underlined the importance of ensuring that innovation reaches the grassroots and creates tangible benefits for communities. He highlighted the transformational impact of Jal Jeevan Mission, noting that under the leadership of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, the programme has significantly improved the lives of rural families by extending tap water connectivity to crores of households across the country.

At the same time, he stressed that access to water alone is not sufficient and that the focus must now shift towards ensuring the safety and quality of the water being supplied.

Shri Patil said that water quality



Figure :21 | Address by MoJS during the Grand Finale - DDWS Innovation Challenge | Source: NJJM

remains a key priority for the Government. While substantial infrastructure has been created under Jal Jeevan Mission, timely testing and monitoring of drinking water continue to pose challenges in several remote regions. In many villages, access to testing facilities remains limited, making it difficult to identify contamination issues quickly and take corrective measures.

To address this gap, he called upon researchers, scientists and start-ups to create affordable and easy-to-use technologies that can be deployed at the village level. Such solutions, he said, should enable Gram Panchayats, Village Water and Sanitation Committees (VWSCs), Self-Help Groups and local youth to participate directly in water quality monitoring and management.

Portable devices, field-testing kits and low-cost testing technologies could significantly improve rural water surveillance systems while empowering local communities to ensure the safety of their drinking water, he noted.

Shri Patil also highlighted the growing concern of plastic waste management in rural India. As packaged

“Technology becomes truly successful only when it reaches people and is easy for communities to use. The mission must now move forward with equal focus on water safety, ensuring that every household receives not only water, but safe drinking water.”

**Shri C.R.Patil, Minister of Jal Shakti**

products become increasingly available in villages, the volume of plastic waste, particularly multi-layer plastic waste such as chips packets, biscuit wrappers and pouches, has risen steadily.

He pointed out that transporting such waste to distant recycling facilities is often costly and operationally difficult, especially in geographically dispersed rural areas. As a result, there is a growing need for decentralized solutions that can process waste closer to where it is generated. He emphasised that village-level and block-level solutions are needed to process plastic waste locally and support the idea of Circular Economy by converting waste into wealth.

According to him, innovative technologies should be tailored to

local needs, simple enough for communities to operate and capable of generating livelihood opportunities. Such solutions can simultaneously address environmental concerns, create rural enterprises and strengthen local economies.

He added that encouraging innovation-led entrepreneurship among village youth aligns closely with the vision of Aatmanirbhar Bharat and contributes to India's broader aspiration of becoming a Viksit Bharat.

One of the key highlights of the event was the recognition of six winning technologies selected through the Innovation Challenge.

Under Jal Jeevan Mission category, Chembiosens Pvt. Ltd., Jaljyoti

Process Pvt. Ltd. and Plastic Surge Industries Pvt. Ltd. were selected for their innovative solutions focused on portable water quality testing devices, chemical and bacteriological testing technologies and field-testing kits. These solutions aim to make water quality assessment more accessible, reliable and efficient, particularly at the village level where quick testing capabilities are often lacking.

The technologies are expected to help strengthen local monitoring systems by enabling faster detection of contaminants and improving the overall effectiveness of water quality surveillance mechanisms.

Under the Swachh Bharat Mission (Grameen) category, Crosslinx Pvt. Ltd., BiGlyso Pvt. Ltd. and Vigya Crafts

Pvt. Ltd. emerged as winners. Their innovations focused on affordable plastic waste management systems, sustainable processing models and localized technologies capable of handling plastic waste on a smaller scale.

These solutions seek to reduce dependence on centralized waste-processing facilities by promoting decentralized recycling and resource recovery. Besides reducing environmental impacts, the technologies have the potential to lower transportation costs and create local economic opportunities through waste management activities. The awards were presented to the winners by Shri C.R. Patil during the event.

Importantly, the selected technolo-



Figure :22 | Grand Finale - DDWS Innovation Challenge, certificates awarded by MoJS | Source: NJJM

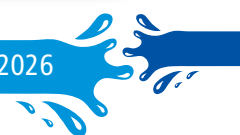




Figure :23 | Grand Finale – DDWS Innovation Challenge, certificates awarded by MoJS | Source: NJJM

gies will now undergo further examination to assess their safety, practicality, scalability and overall suitability for deployment in rural areas. Based on their performance, the Department may explore pilot implementation in selected locations to evaluate their effectiveness under real-world conditions.

Speaking on the occasion, Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation, underscored the critical role of innovation in ensuring the long-term sustainability of rural drinking water supply and sanitation systems.

He noted that while Jal Jeevan Mission and Swachh Bharat Mission-Grameen have created substantial infrastructure in rural India, the next phase of development must focus on ensuring reliable, affordable and sustainable service delivery through technology-driven interventions.

Highlighting the objectives of the Innovation Challenge, Shri Meena said the initiative was designed to identify practical solutions that could address persistent challenges in water quality monitoring and plastic waste management. Technologies intended for rural India, he observed, must be simple, affordable, durable and suitable for field conditions if they are to achieve widespread adoption

Shri Meena also emphasized the potential of digital technologies in strengthening water quality surveillance. Portable testing devices integrated with mobile applications could significantly improve transparency, speed and reliability by enabling real-time data collection, geo-tagging and rapid reporting from the field.

Such innovations, he said, can contribute to better decision-making, faster response mechanisms and

enhanced public confidence in rural drinking water services.

On plastic waste management, Shri Meena advocated moving beyond traditional collection-and-disposal approaches toward decentralized circular economy models. He noted that innovations promoting local recycling, reuse and resource recovery can reduce environmental impacts while simultaneously creating livelihood opportunities and supporting sustainable waste management systems in rural areas.

Congratulating the winners, he expressed confidence that the innovations recognised through the challenge would extend beyond the competition and contribute meaningfully to improving service delivery, strengthening community institutions and enhancing the ease of living in rural India.

The event also featured a presenta-



Figure :24 | Presentation by IIT-Madras during the Grand Finale - DDWS Innovation Challenge | Source: NJJM

tion by **IIT Madras**, led by **Prof. Ligy Philip**, which outlined the journey of the Innovation Challenge, including its evaluation criteria, selection methodology and overall implementation process. The presentation highlighted the rigorous approach adopted to identify technologies with the greatest potential for large-scale impact.

The DDWS Innovation Challenge demonstrated how collaboration between government institutions, academia and the start-up ecosystem can generate practical solutions to pressing developmental challenges. More importantly, it reinforced the message that innovation is most effective when it is accessible, affordable and rooted in the realities of the communities it seeks to serve.

As India continues to strengthen rural infrastructure under Jal Jeevan Mission and Swachh Bharat Mission (Grameen), initiatives such as the DDWS Innovation Challenge are expected to play an important role in ensuring that technological progress translates into safer drinking water, cleaner villages, stronger local institutions and more sustainable livelihoods. Ultimately, the challenge showcased a simple yet powerful idea articulated by the Union Minister—that technology succeeds not merely when it is invented, but when it reaches people and improves their daily lives.



Figure :25 | All in a frame during the Grand Finale - DDWS Innovation Challenge | Source: NJJM



## Sujal Gram Samvad Strengthens Community -Led Water Governance: Five Gram Panchayats Share Rural Water Success Stories in 8th Edition

- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU-NJJM

**T**he Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti, organised the **eighth edition of the multilingual Sujal Gram Samvad on 25th June 2026**. Sujal Gram Samvad is a unique platform designed to connect policymakers, state officials, district administrations, Gram Panchayats and rural communities on issues related to drinking water security and sustainable water management. Conducted under the framework of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0, the Samvad highlighted the growing role of Panchayati Raj Institutions in ensuring safe, reliable and sustainable drinking water services in rural India.

The programme was chaired by Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary and Mission Director, National Jal Jeevan Mission (NJJM), and witnessed participation from

senior officials of the Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation, State Water and Sanitation Missions, District Water and Sanitation Missions, Gram Panchayat representatives, Village Water and Sanitation Committees (VWSCs), Self-Help Groups (SHGs), Jal Doots, Anganwadi workers, school students and community members.

The eighth edition saw interactions with five Gram Panchayat headquarters villages spread across **Assam, Karnataka, Haryana, Tripura and the Union Territory of Ladakh**. More than **3,000 people joined virtually**, while many more attended from village-level community gathering points. The multilingual format enabled discussions in Assamese, Kannada, Haryanvi, Bengali and Hindi, allowing villagers to communicate their experiences in their native languages

### Panchayats at the Centre of Water Security

In his opening remarks, Shri Kamal Kishore Soan underscored the transformative journey of rural drinking water service delivery since the launch of Jal Jeevan Mission in 2019. He observed that India had made remarkable progress in prioritising household tap water access, with more than six lakh villages now covered under the mission.

He emphasised that the success of the programme has been driven not merely by infrastructure creation but by active community participation. Panchayats, Gram Sabhas, Self-Help Groups, Village Water and Sanitation Committees and local operators such as Nal Jal Mitras have emerged as crucial partners in planning, implementing and maintaining rural water supply systems.



Figure :26 | Chair the 8<sup>th</sup> SGS by AS&MD, NJJM | Source: NJJM



Figure :27 | Virtual attendance from across rural belt | Source: NJJM

According to Shri Soan, the water supply infrastructure being built under Jal Jeevan Mission is expected to serve communities for the next 25 to 30 years. Therefore, rural local bodies must focus on long-term sustainability by ensuring source protection, routine maintenance, efficient operation, prevention of water wastage and capacity building of local technical personnel.

A major emphasis was also placed on water quality management. Referring to the nationwide **STOP Diarrhoea** Campaign, he highlighted the importance of regular testing of drinking water sources and household water supplies. With the monsoon season underway, he urged Panchayats and community institutions to remain vigilant against contamination and to activate local monitoring systems involving trained women volunteers and community workers.

## Planning for the Future under the 16<sup>th</sup> Finance Commission

Addressing district and state officials, Shri Soan drew attention to the importance of Gram Panchayat Development Plans (GPDPs) in sustaining rural water services. He noted that the grant period of the

15th Finance Commission had concluded in March 2026 and that implementation under the 16th Finance Commission had commenced.

He informed participants that timely preparation of GPDPs would be a critical requirement for accessing funds under the new Finance Commission framework. He urged all Panchayats and district administrations to complete their GPDPs before the stipulated deadline of 15 August 2026, stressing that effective planning would determine the long-term success of rural drinking water systems.

The Samvad highlighted that water security is no longer viewed only as a matter of infrastructure creation but as a continuous process involving maintenance, financial sustainability, source conservation, water quality surveillance and participatory governance.

## Learning from the Villages

One of the defining features of Sujal Gram Samvad is its direct engagement with rural communities. The discussions covered the challenges experienced by villages before the implementation of Jal Jeevan Mission and the changes witnessed since gaining access to functional household tap connections.

Across all five locations, participants reported substantial improvements in quality of life, reduced drudgery for women, improved conditions in schools and Anganwadi centres, strengthened community participation and greater awareness regarding water conservation and quality monitoring.

Each Gram Panchayat presented unique experiences that reflected local geographical, climatic and social realities while demonstrating how community-led management can strengthen rural water security.



Figure :28 | Opening remark by AS&MD, NJJM | Source: NJJM



## Assam



### GP Murrobori, Morigaon District, Assam



- Regular water quality monitoring through Field Testing Kits.
- Active participation of Self-Help Groups in ensuring safe drinking water.
- Coordination meetings involving Panchayat, VWSC, schools and community institutions.
- Focus on strengthening operation and maintenance activities and development planning.

Representatives from GP Murrobori interacted in Assamese and outlined the active role played by Self-Help Groups and community institutions in supporting Jal Jeevan Mission implementation. Women associated with SHGs described how village-level efforts had significantly improved access to safe drinking water.

The village reported a structured approach to water quality monitoring, with trained community members regularly using Field Testing Kits (FTKs) to test drinking water sources. Test results are reviewed through community meetings and submitted to relevant authorities to ensure corrective actions wherever required.

Representatives highlighted the strong local governance mechanisms

operating within the Panchayat. Regular coordination meetings involving the Panchayat President, school teachers, VWSC members and GPDC representatives help identify and resolve local water-related challenges.

District and state officials participating in the Samvad assured villagers that issues related to the water supply system would continue to receive attention through coordinated efforts involving Gram Panchayats and the

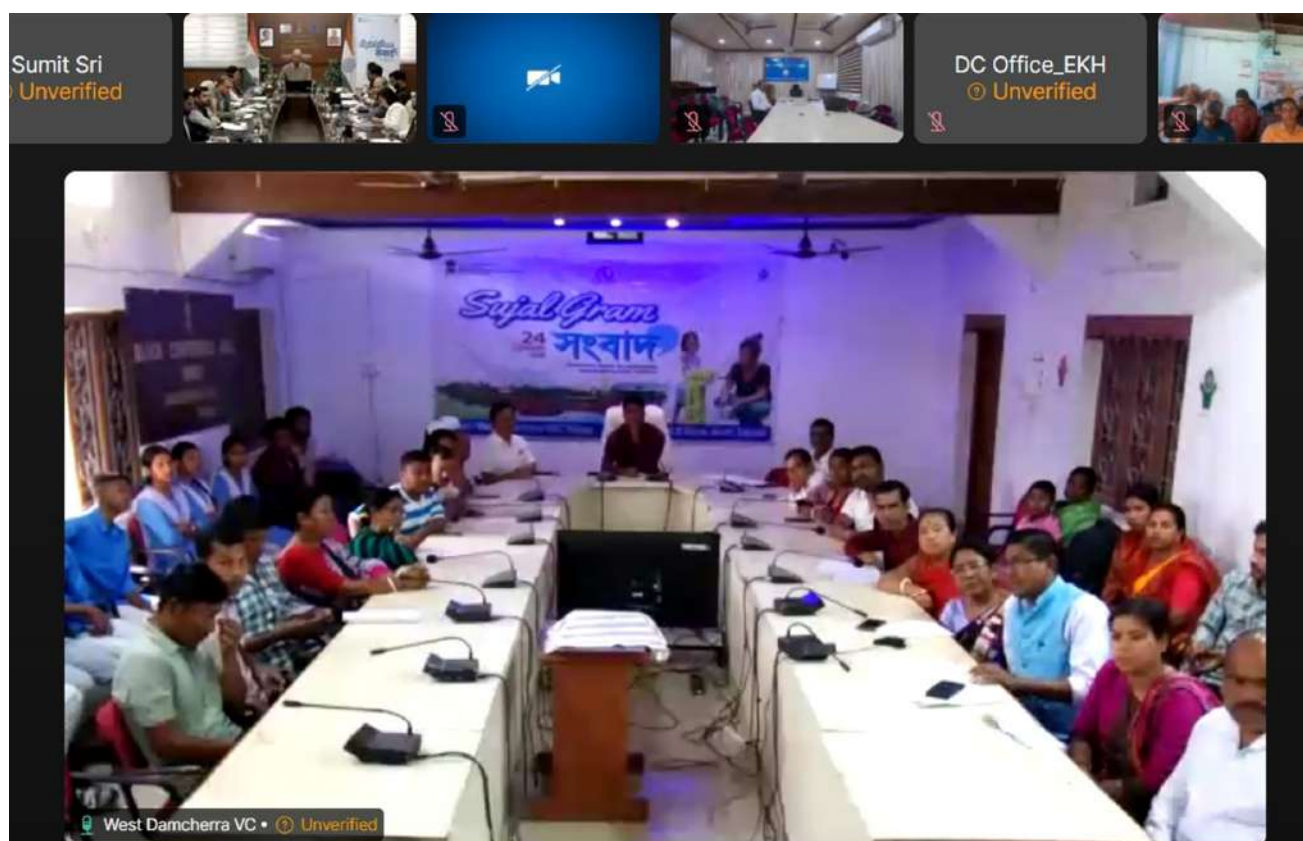


Figure :29 | Dialogue by community in local language | Source: NJJM



Public Health Engineering Department. Officials also encouraged timely preparation of GDPs and District Improvement Plans to leverage opportunities under the 16th Finance Commission framework.



Figure :30 | Community from Murrobori GP interacting in Assamese | Source: NJJM



Figure :31 | DC, Morigaon District interacting during SGS | Source: NJJM



Figure :32 | SWSM officials interacting during SGS | Source: NJJM

## Karnataka



### GP Dodda Jala, Bengaluru Urban District, Karnataka



- ◆ Universal household tap water coverage achieved under JJM.
- ◆ ₹50 monthly user charges supporting sustainable operation and maintenance.
- ◆ Strong community ownership of village water infrastructure.
- ◆ Active implementation of Jal Seva Aankalan and Jal Arpan Diwas.
- ◆ Focus on strengthening operation and maintenance activities and development planning.



The interaction from GP Dodda Jala was conducted in Kannada and showcased a Gram Panchayat where every household has received a Functional Household Tap Connection (FHTC) under Jal Jeevan Mission.

Village representatives credited this achievement to strong community participation and collective efforts. A structured user-fee system has been established wherein each household contributes ₹50 every month towards the operation and maintenance of the water supply system.

Despite the success, villagers openly discussed operational challenges. A significant issue identified was the unauthorised tampering of control valves by some residents, resulting in inequitable water distribution, particularly affecting households located at the tail end of the network.

Officials from District and State Water and Sanitation Missions informed

participants that implementation of Jal Jeevan Mission was progressing steadily throughout Karnataka. They noted that timely reviews, Jal Seva Aankalan exercises and proper hand-over processes through Jal Arpan were helping strengthen service delivery.

Shri Kamal Kishore Soan commended Karnataka's performance in the Jal Seva Aankalan initiative and encouraged the state to maintain its leadership role in implementing the objectives of Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0.



Figure :33 | Dialogue by community in local language | Source: NJJM



Figure :34 | CEO Zilaa Parisad, Bengaluru Urban District interacting during SGS | Source: NJJM

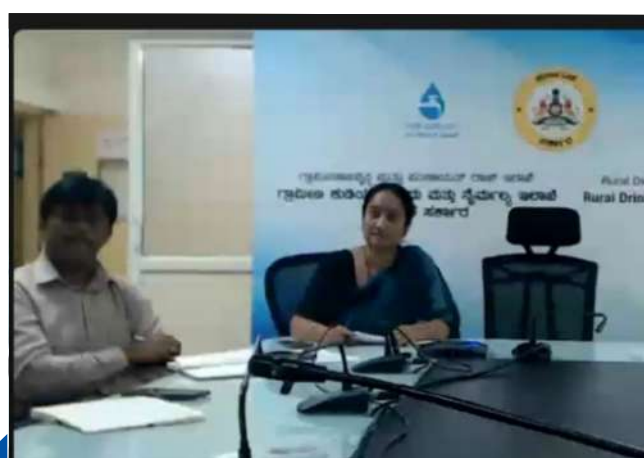


Figure :34 | SWSM officials interacting during SGS | Source: NJJM

## Haryana



### GP Amarpur, Palwal District, Haryana



- ◆ Sustainable user-charge system generating monthly O&M resources.
- ◆ Regular water quality testing conducted twice every month.
- ◆ Strong involvement of women in water conservation awareness.
- ◆ Progress from ODF Plus towards Water Plus status.
- ◆ Focus on strengthening operation and maintenance activities and development planning.

The interaction with GP Amarpur was conducted in Haryanvi and highlighted an impressive example of Panchayat-led management and financial sustainability. Village representatives explained that regular user charges are collected from households, with ₹40 charged from general category families and ₹20 from SC/BC households. The collected revenue is used for maintenance of pipelines, repair of leakages and other operational expenses.

Community participation has enabled the Panchayat to generate a monthly collection of approximately ₹7,000–8,000, demonstrating the viability of locally managed water systems. Villagers also reported conducting water quality testing twice every month and undertaking awareness campaigns focused on water conservation.

Women participants played a particularly prominent role during the discussion. They described door-to-door communication efforts encouraging households to use water judiciously and adopt conservation practices. They also spoke about initiatives centred on reuse of wastewater and source sustainability.

District officials highlighted that Amarpur has already been declared ODF Plus and is working toward achieving Water Plus status. Haryana officials also pointed out that the state's operation and maintenance policy promotes Panchayat-led management, supported through incentive mechanisms linked to user charge collection.

More than 400 Panchayats across Haryana have already signed agreements to manage water supply systems through community-based models, demonstrating the scalability of such practices.



Figure :35 | Community of Amarpur GP interacting in Hariyanvi | Source: NJJM





Figure :36 | DC, Palwal District interacting during SGS |  
Source: NJJM



Figure :37 | SWSM interacting during SGS  
Source: NJJM

## Tripura



### GP Ratanpur, South Tripura District, Tripura

- ◆ Universal drinking water coverage for households, schools and Anganwadis.
- ◆ Functional grievance redressal system with quick fault resolution.
- ◆ Monthly water quality testing by VWSC members.
- ◆ Integration of village plans into GPDP through e-Gram Swaraj.
- ◆ Focus on strengthening operation and maintenance activities and development planning.



Representatives from GP Ratanpur interacted in Bengali and provided insights into how Jal Jeevan Mission has transformed everyday life for residents.

According to community members, every household in the village, along with schools and Anganwadi centres, has received tap water connectivity. Villagers reported receiving adequate quantities of water from borewell-based supply systems, eliminating the burden of collecting water from distant sources.

The Gram Panchayat has established a functional grievance redressal mechanism through a complaint register. Local operators respond quickly to reported issues, with minor faults typically resolved within two to three days.

Water quality surveillance forms an important component of village management. VWSC members conduct monthly testing using Field Testing Kits and maintain records of results. During the interaction, school students confirmed the availability of safe drinking water and separate

sanitation facilities on school premises.

District authorities informed the Samvad that the village's action plan had been integrated into the Gram Panchayat Development Plan through the e-Gram Swaraj platform. Officials also reported the completion of Jal Utsav, Jal Arpan and Nal Jal Mitra training initiatives across Gram Panchayats.

State officials highlighted their extensive IEC campaigns, the availability of NABL-accredited laboratories at multiple levels and ongoing efforts to strengthen local technical capacity through Nal Jal Mitra training.



Figure :38 | Community from Ratanpur GP interacting in Bengali | Source: NJJM



Figure :39 | DC, South Tripura District interacting during SGS | Source: NJJM



Figure :40 | SWSM interacting during SGS | Source: NJJM

## Ladakh



### GP Gindiya, Kargil District, Ladakh



- ◆ Universal tap water access despite extreme climatic conditions.
- ◆ Winter-proof infrastructure with frost-line pipelines and insulation.
- ◆ Local operators and trained women conducting regular water testing.
- ◆ Effective grievance redressal through digital and community mechanisms.
- ◆ Focus on strengthening operation and maintenance activities and development planning.

The interaction from GP Gindiya in Kargil offered perhaps the most compelling account of transformation under Jal Jeevan Mission due to the region's harsh climatic conditions.

Communicating in Hindi, villagers recalled the severe hardships faced before the arrival of household tap water. Women often travelled seven to ten kilometres to collect water and, during winter, were forced to break ice in temperatures



dropping to minus forty degrees Celsius. Today, tap water connections reach every household, school and Anganwadi centre. This has dramatically reduced the physical burden on families and improved overall quality of life.

The village showcased several innovative engineering adaptations designed for extreme weather conditions. Pipelines have been laid below frost lines, insulation has been provided in rocky stretches and natural spring sources have been carefully mapped and integrated into water supply planning.

The Panchayat has invested in local capacity building by procuring tools and training operators. Five operators and trained women regularly conduct water quality testing using FTKs and send samples to district laboratories. Rapid grievance redressal mechanisms have also been established through complaint registers and dedicated WhatsApp groups. Minor technical issues are typically addressed within a few days.

Deputy Commissioner Shri Rakesh Kumar outlined extensive efforts undertaken across Kargil, including completion of Nal Jal Mitra training in

170 Gram Panchayats and Village Committees. He stressed the importance of spring source mapping, winter-proof engineering measures and continuous monitoring.

Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, recalling his previous visit to Ladakh, highlighted concerns regarding contamination of spring water through drainage mixing in certain areas. He strongly emphasised the need for robust monitoring systems and preventive action to protect drinking water quality.



Figure :41 | Community from Gindhial GP interacting in Hindi | Source: NJJM



Figure :42 | DC, Kargil District interacting during SGS  
Source: NJJM

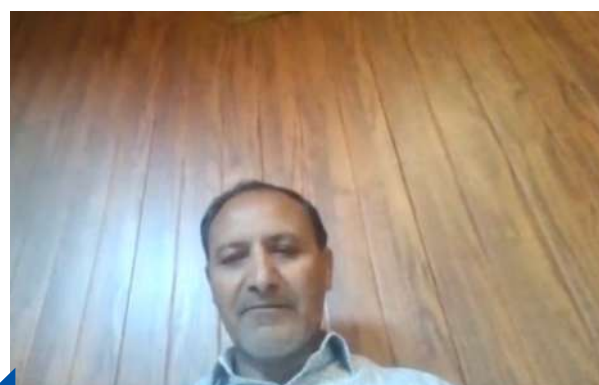


Figure :43 | SWSM interacting during SGS  
Source: NJJM

## A Model for Participatory Water Governance

In his concluding remarks, Shri Kamal Kishore Soan expressed appreciation for the commitment demonstrated by District Collectors, Gram Panchayats and community institutions. He emphasised that the experiences shared during the Samvad demonstrated how transparency, participation and accountability can strengthen rural water service delivery.

He reiterated that Jal Seva Aankalan should be viewed as a fact-finding and improvement-oriented exercise rather than a compliance requirement. Identifying gaps early, he noted, would prevent larger challenges in the future.

The Additional Secretary urged district administrations to conduct regular District Water and Sanitation Mission meetings and dedicate focused attention each month to water and sanitation issues. Such continuous monitoring, combined with active Panchayat leadership and community participation, would help ensure long-term sustainability of rural water systems.

The programme concluded with observations from Shri Y.K. Singh,

Director, NJJM, who reaffirmed that Sujal Gram Samvad is designed to listen directly to village communities, understand local experiences and learn about innovative practices related to operation and maintenance as well as source sustainability.

The eighth edition of Sujal Gram Samvad demonstrated that the future of rural water security lies not only in infrastructure creation but in empowering communities to take ownership of water resources. The experiences shared from Assam, Karnataka, Haryana, Tripura and Ladakh collectively illustrated how community-driven governance can transform water service delivery while ensuring sustainability for generations to come.



Figure :44 | Dialogue by community in local language | Source: NJJM



## DDWS Organises 9th District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad to Accelerate JJM 2.0 Implementation and Strengthen Service Delivery

- Lopamudra Panda, NPMU-NJJM

The Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti, organised the 9th edition of the District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad through video conferencing, bringing together senior officials, District Collectors/Deputy Commissioners, and Mission Directors of State/UT Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM). The Samvad served as an important platform for deliberation on accelerating the implementation of JJM 2.0 while facilitating the sharing of field-level experiences and best practices from across the country. It reaffirmed the central role of districts in ensuring last-mile delivery, sustainability of assets, and strengthening community

ownership of rural water supply systems. Five Districts Showcased Innovative Practices on Source Sustainability, Jan Bhagidari, Women empowerment and O&M of piped water supply systems.

The Samvad was chaired by Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Secretary, DDWS. Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary and Mission Director, National Jal Jeevan Mission (NJJM), along with other senior officials from DDWS, present in the samvad. The event witnessed active engagement from districts and states, reflecting the increasing importance of decentralised planning and monitoring under JJM 2.0.

In his address, Shri Ashok K.K. Meena highlighted that the focus of JJM 2.0 has gradually shifted from infrastructure creation to ensuring reliable and sustainable service delivery. He emphasised that provision of tap connections alone is not sufficient; what is now critical is functionality, sustainability of water sources, and institutionalisation of community-led operation and maintenance systems. He underscored that district administrations have a pivotal role to play in ensuring that assets created under the Mission continue to function effectively and deliver safe drinking water on a regular basis.

The Secretary outlined three key



Figure :45 | Secretary, DDWS chairing 9th DCPS | Source: NJJM

priority areas for districts under JJM 2.0:

- First, he stressed the importance of conducting regular District Water and Sanitation Mission (DWSM) meetings. These meetings, he noted, should be held every month without exception and must be documented through timely uploading of minutes on the designated dashboard. Regular DWSM meetings serve as a critical institutional mechanism for reviewing the progress of drinking water schemes, addressing operational challenges, monitoring O&M, and ensuring accountability at the district level. He further indicated that the conduct and quality of these meetings would be closely monitored and reflected in district performance assess-

ments, thereby reinforcing the need for seriousness and consistency.

- Second, he underlined the significance of the Jal Seva Aankalan process, which provides an annual assessment of drinking water service delivery. He encouraged districts to familiarise themselves with the methodology and indicators of the assessment, and more importantly, to use its findings as a practical tool for improving service delivery on the ground. Rather than treating it as a compliance exercise, he emphasised that Jal Seva Aankalan should guide evidence-based planning and course correction.
- Third, he highlighted the importance of the Jal Arpan ceremony

as a means to strengthen community ownership. He explained that the commissioning of water supply schemes should be accompanied by their formal handover to Gram Panchayats after successful trial runs of 15 to 30 days. This process ensures that local institutions are fully prepared to take responsibility for operation and maintenance. He encouraged districts to organise Jal Arpan ceremonies as community-centric events with participation from public representatives, including MPs, MLAs, Panchayat members, and local communities, thereby reinforcing public accountability and local pride in achieving safe drinking water access.

Shri Meena expressed confidence that the exchange of best practices during the Peyjal Samvad would

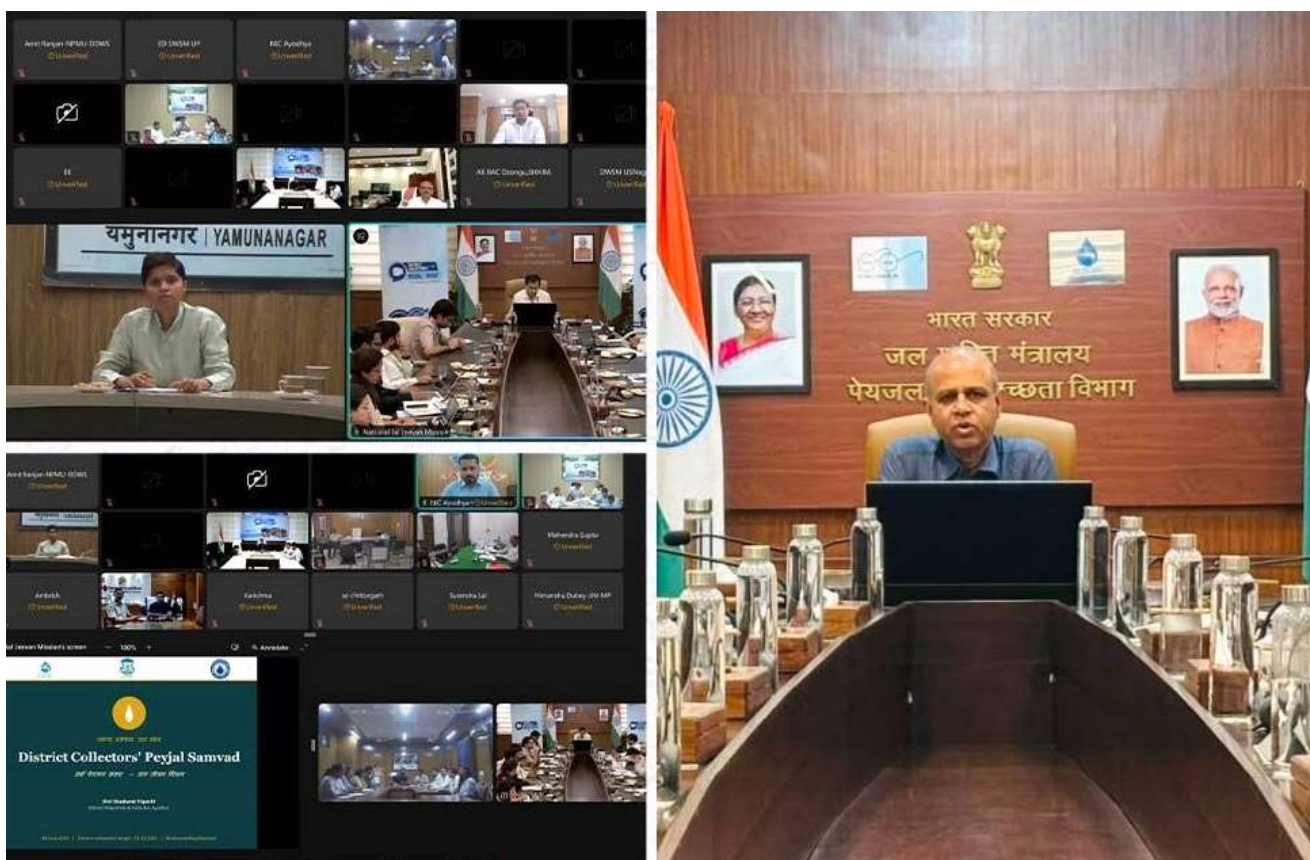


Figure :46 | Secretary, DDWS delivering his address in 9th DCPS | Source: NUJM



motivate districts to learn from each other's experiences and improve their performance, ultimately contributing to the Mission's larger goal of ensuring sustainable drinking water services for every rural household.

Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary and Mission Director, NJJM, in his address reinforced the importance of institutional mechanisms and effective coordination at the district level. He reiterated that DWSM meetings must be conducted regularly, and their proceedings uploaded promptly on the portal to maintain transparency and facilitate monitoring. He emphasised that source sustainability must remain a top priority, especially in the context of increasing stress on groundwater resources.

He advised districts to study successful models of source sustainability and explore ways of standardising and replicating them across different regions. Maintaining groundwater levels, he noted, is essential for ensuring the long-term functionality of rural water supply schemes. To strengthen convergence, he suggested that officers related to water conservation, groundwater recharge, irrigation, water resources, and Jal

Sanchay se Jal Bhagidari initiatives should be invited to DWSM meetings. This would enable holistic planning, improve inter-departmental coordination, and provide a clearer understanding of local water resource dynamics.

He also highlighted the need for closer coordination with the Agriculture Department for the installation of automatic rain gauges across Gram Panchayats. Such systems would allow districts to monitor local rainfall patterns more accurately, understand groundwater behaviour, and plan context-specific interventions to sustain water sources. This data-driven approach would support more resilient water management practices at the local level.

On the Jal Arpan initiative, Shri Soan emphasised that it should not be treated as a symbolic exercise. Its true objective is to promote Jan Bhagidari and foster a sense of ownership among communities. He stressed that before handing over schemes to Gram Panchayats, trial runs must be completed and detailed information regarding the scheme, including technical designs, cost estimates, and operational guidelines, should be shared transparently with the

community. He also urged district administrations to prepare and adhere to monthly Jal Arpan calendars to ensure systematic implementation.

Further, he drew attention to the effective utilization of Finance Commission (FC) grants. He advised that unutilised 15th FC tied grants should be appropriately aligned with the guidance under the 16th FC, ensuring continuity and optimal deployment of resources.

These funds, he noted, should be integrated with district-level priorities identified through District Improvement Plans, thereby addressing gaps in service delivery and strengthening O&M systems. He emphasised that timely utilisation of funds, adherence to financial guidelines, and robust planning are crucial for sustaining the infrastructure created under JJM.

## DDWS Presentation on 16th Finance Commission Grants for WaSH

A detailed presentation was made by Shri Y.K. Singh, Director (NJJM), on the role of 16th Finance Commission grants in strengthening water, sanitation, and hygiene (WaSH) services in rural areas. He explained that with substantial progress already achieved under JJM in terms of infrastructure, the focus must now shift towards sustaining these assets and ensuring consistent service delivery.

In this context, the role of Gram Panchayats becomes central, as they are responsible for managing in-village water supply systems, maintaining water quality, and ensuring sanitation services.

The presentation highlighted that Finance Commission grants, supplemented by user charges, provide a



Figure :47 | AS&MD NJJM interacting with district administrations in 9<sup>th</sup> DCPS | Source: NJJM



stable financial framework for meeting operation and maintenance costs. Out of the total allocation of over ₹4.35 lakh crore under the 16th Finance Commission, 50 percent of the basic grants—amounting to approximately ₹1.74 lakh crore—are tied to water and sanitation. These funds can be utilised for a wide range of activities such as source strengthening, chlorination, repair and maintenance of infrastructure, procurement of water testing kits, payment of operators, and covering energy costs.

Additionally, they support sanitation initiatives including maintenance of community sanitation assets, greywater management, waste management systems, and construction of sanitation infrastructure.

He emphasised that these resources must be effectively planned through Gram Panchayat Development Plans (GPDPs), approved by Gram Sabhas and monitored through digital platforms such as eGram Swaraj and PFMS. Ensuring timely utilisation, adherence to audit requirements, and proper reporting are essential for maximising the impact of these grants

## Innovative Best Practices Shared by Districts Through Presentations

During the Peyjal Samvad, a total of five districts presented their progress and best field practices which will further help other State's districts to develop better under JJM 2.0. Each presentation was delivered by the respective District Collector/ District Magistrate/Deputy Commissioner/ District Officials.

Una, Himachal Pradesh - Shri Jatin Lal, Deputy Commissioner presented the district's progress, achievements, and initiatives. He

shared that Una faces issues related to scattered habitations, dependence on pumping schemes, voltage fluctuations, power outages, permissions from different departments. The district has also faced challenges arising from floods and natural disasters, for which field teams and disaster volunteers have been mobilized to minimize disruption and assess damages in pipelines.

The Deputy Commissioner informed that the district has taken steps to recharge groundwater during the monsoon period and maintain water sources for long-term water security,



strengthening of district technical units, activation of village-level committees, promotion of digital governance, digital registry, and GIS/GPS-based monitoring of assets and schemes. These initiatives have helped the district improve tracking, transparency, and timely resolution of implementation-related issues.

The district also shared its efforts towards coordination with line departments and local administration for land-related matters, permissions, protection of infrastructure, and smooth implementation of water supply schemes. Regular coordination with departments such as revenue, police, and other administrative agencies has supported faster resolution of field-level challenges.

• **Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh - Shri Shashank Tripathi, District Magistrate** highlighted that regular monitoring is being undertaken through the DWSM. A model scheme at Shadbashpur was showcased, where 24x7 water supply has been ensured, with nearly 700 household connections completed. A notable feature of this scheme is the active involvement of a woman operator in managing the water supply system. Overall, 17 women operators are currently managing various schemes across the district, a model widely appreciated for its potential replication in other regions.

Special emphasis has been placed on road restoration, a key concern for local communities during implementation. The district administration has integrated road restoration within the overall execution plan to minimize inconvenience to villagers.

The presentation also highlighted efforts toward source sustainability

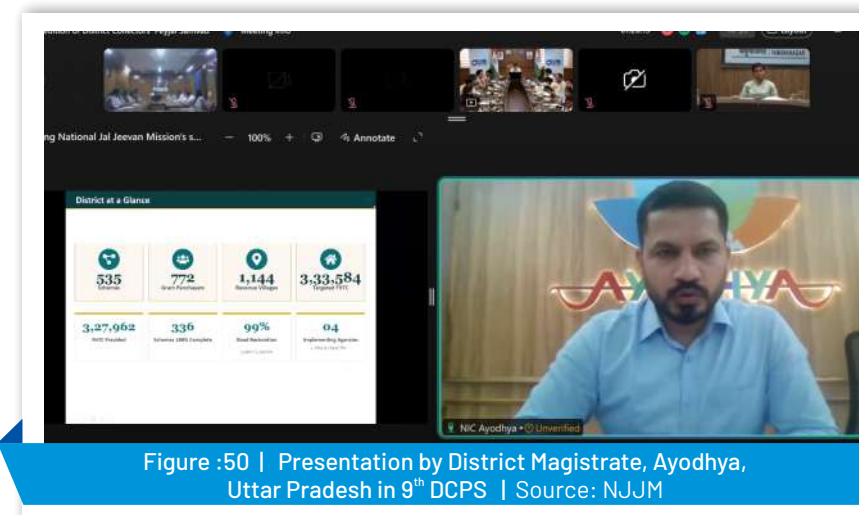


Figure :50 | Presentation by District Magistrate, Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh in 9<sup>th</sup> DCPS | Source: NJJM

and water security. Recharge structures are being promoted at village level through GPs, Blocks, and individual stakeholders, along with rainwater harvesting systems at scheme sites to strengthen ground-water recharge.

Women's participation remains a cornerstone of the programme. Women operators, plumbers, and Self-Help Group members are actively involved in operations, water quality testing, community engagement, and user charge collection. Additionally, a study by King George's Medical University assesses the mission's impact on women's health. Skill development has also been strengthened through a CSR-supported training centre at the Muzaffarpur-Jalalpur scheme site.

• **Yamuna Nagar, Haryana – Ms. Preeti, Deputy Commissioner** that, as part of ongoing reforms, the district has signed 60 Memorandums of Understanding between the Public Health Department and Gram Panchayats for the handover and management of water supply schemes. The district administration further noted that the remaining technical processes related to the handover are being addressed, and the process is being advanced in a time-bound manner.

A major focus of the district's approach has been IEC activities. Awareness campaigns are being conducted across villages, schools, and community groups to reduce water wastage, encourage responsi-

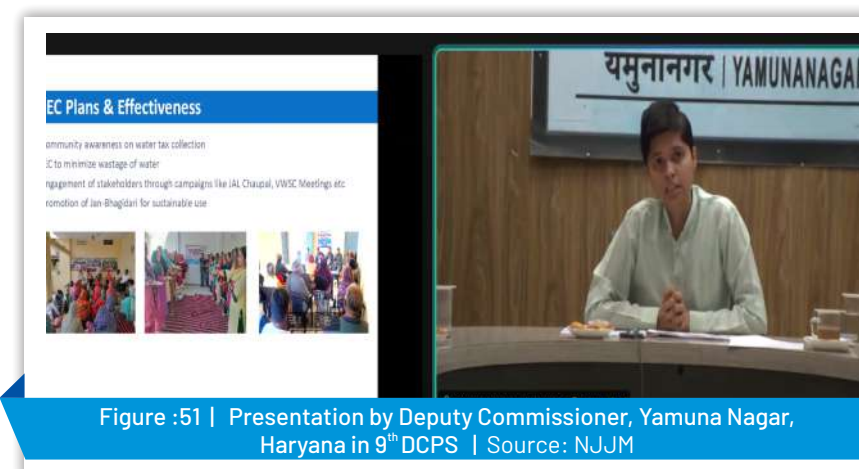


Figure :51 | Presentation by Deputy Commissioner, Yamuna Nagar, Haryana in 9<sup>th</sup> DCPS | Source: NJJM

ble water use, and promote service charge collection. She emphasized the important role of Self-Help Groups (SHGs) in water quality monitoring and community engagement. SHG members have been trained and oriented in water testing protocols, grievance redressal, and quality assurance.

The district also highlighted its efforts toward environmental sustainability. With the support of SHGs, around 1,000 trees have been planted, and members will monitor their growth over the next year. Regular monitoring is undertaken at the district, sub-divisional, and departmental levels, while a 24x7 helpline ensures timely grievance redressal.

◆ **Sivasagar, Assam – Shri Mridul Yadav, Deputy Commissioner** presented the progress under Jal Jeevan Mission, highlighting community-led operation and maintenance, tariff collection, and long-term sustainability of rural water supply schemes. He informed that the district has achieved around 76% tariff collection through convergence with Panchayats, Water User Committees (WUCs), SHGs, and active community participation. Regular DWSM meetings, field inspections, and inter-

departmental reviews are conducted, while PHED and Panchayat officials jointly inspect schemes before handover.

The presentation emphasized the role of PRI representatives, WUCs, and Jal Mitras in ensuring functionality. Trained through ITIs, Jal Mitras support not only pump operations but also minor repairs, maintenance, and tariff collection, reducing dependence on contractors.

A key highlight was the “Nari Shakti Se Jal Shakti” initiative, showcasing women’s leadership in managing water supply systems. Women are actively involved in financial management, tariff collection, and monitoring service delivery, strengthening accountability and community ownership.

Digital innovation was also noted, with QR code-based tariff payments improving transparency and ease of collection. The Hati Muria-Ghatgalia scheme achieved 100% tariff collection across 350 households through strong community management. Even in challenging terrains near the Nagaland border, behavioural change has encouraged communities to contribute user charges, ensuring sustainability.

◆ **Septhajala, Tripura – Dr. Siddharth Shiv Jaiswal, District Magistrate & Collector** presented the district's progress under JJM, highlighting significant achievements in rural drinking water coverage and sustainability initiatives. The district has achieved 86.46% tap connections coverage across 108 villages, a substantial improvement from just 3% coverage before the launch of the Mission. The remaining households are expected to be covered upon commissioning of ongoing schemes.

He said that regular DWSM meetings are being conducted every month, complemented by technical inspections, third-party audits, and timely corrective actions. A robust grievance redressal mechanism through the state's public complaint portal has enabled prompt resolution of drinking water-related issues.

To strengthen source sustainability, the district is constructing 300 groundwater recharge structures, of which 82 have already been completed. These efforts contributed to the district receiving the prestigious National Water Award. Convergence with schemes such as VB-GRAM G is also being leveraged for water conservation and sustainability measures.

Jal Seva Aankalan and Jal Arpan Divas helped enhancing community participation and ownership of water supply systems. Extensive IEC activities, including school outreach, village campaigns, and training of 650 women in water quality testing using FTKs, are being undertaken to ensure long-term sustainability and safe drinking water for all.

challenges while advancing the objectives of Jal Jeevan Mission. They highlighted that innovation,

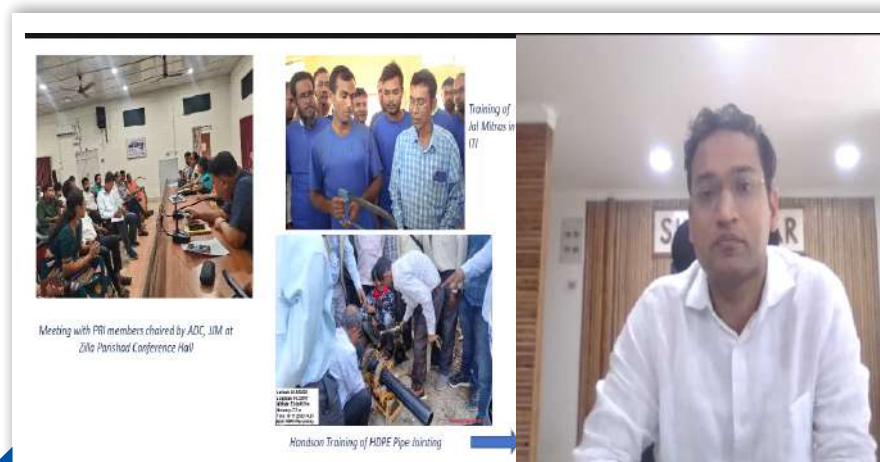
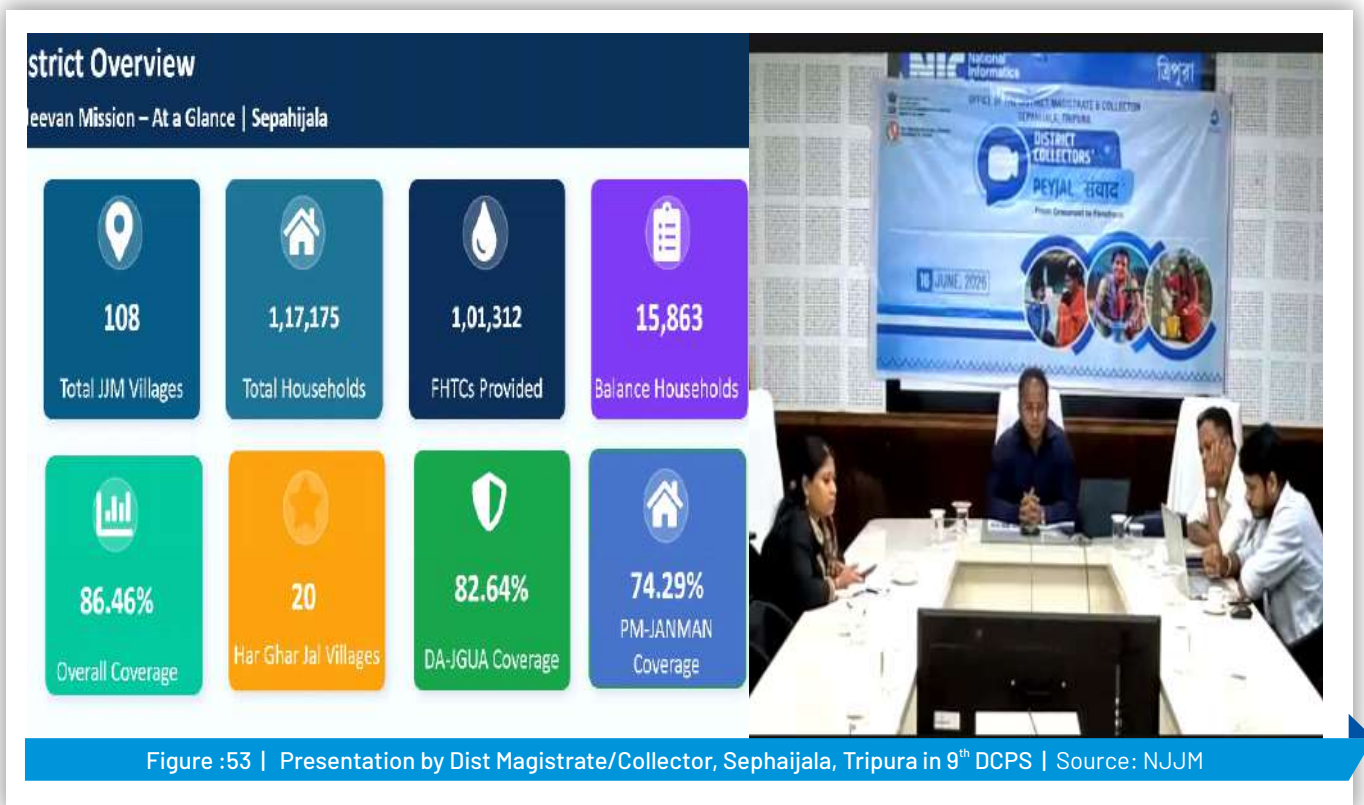


Figure :52 | Presentation by Deputy Commissioner, Sivasagar, Assam in 9<sup>th</sup> DCPS | Source: NJJM





community participation, convergence, and effective use of technology are key drivers of success.

In his concluding remarks, Shri Kamal Kishore Soan commended the districts for their innovative practices and reiterated that the success of JJM 2.0 depends significantly on the proactive leadership of District Collectors and local institutions. He

emphasised that continued learning, collaboration, and commitment at all levels will be essential for achieving the Mission's goal of ensuring safe, reliable, and sustainable drinking water for every rural household.

The 9<sup>th</sup> District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad witnessed wide participation from across the country, including District Collectors, Deputy Commis-

sioners, state officials, and Mission teams. The discussions and insights shared during the Samvad are expected to further strengthen the implementation framework of JJM 2.0 and accelerate progress towards achieving universal and sustainable water security in rural India.



# 16<sup>th</sup> Finance Commission Grant to RLBs: Strengthening Rural Water and Sanitation Service Delivery

—Y.K Singh, Director, NJJM



**Yogendra Kumar Singh**

As India moves steadily towards universal access to safe drinking water under the Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), the focus is evolving from infrastructure creation to ensuring sustainability, functionality, and community-led service delivery. This transition requires not only

technical systems but also strong institutions, reliable financing, and accountable governance at the grassroots level. In this context, the Operational Guidelines of the 16th Finance Commission (2026–31) assume critical importance. **With a total recommended allocation of ₹4.35 lakh crore** for Rural Local Bodies (RLBs), the Commission has significantly strengthened the financial backbone of Panchayati Raj Institutions, enabling them to take greater ownership of water supply and sanitation systems.

## Structuring Funds for Outcomes

community-led service delivery. This transition requires not only technical systems but also strong institutions, reliable financing, and

accountable governance at the grassroots level.

The design of the 16th Finance Commission grants reflects a deliberate shift towards linking finance with outcomes. **Of the total allocation, 80% is provided as basic grants, while 20% is tied to performance**, encouraging improved governance and service delivery. A notable feature is that **50% of the basic grants are tied specifically to water supply and sanitation**, amounting to approximately ₹1.74 lakh crore over the five-year period. The year-wise allocation of tied grants shows a steady increase from about ₹27,955 crore in 2026–27 to ₹42,437 crore by 2030–31 highlighting a sustained commitment to strengthening these critical sectors.

### 16th Finance Commission (FC-16): Key Highlights for States (RLB Grants)

Department of Expenditure, Ministry of Finance issued **Sixteenth Finance Commission Operational Guidelines (2026–31)** to all States.



Figure :54 | Presentation on 16th FC during 9th DCPS | Source: NJJM





## Total Tied Grant Allocation (2026-31)

FC-16 has recommended a total tied grant pool of ₹ ~1,74,094 Crore. The year-wise breakdown shows a steady increase in rural local funding (Figures in ₹ Crore):

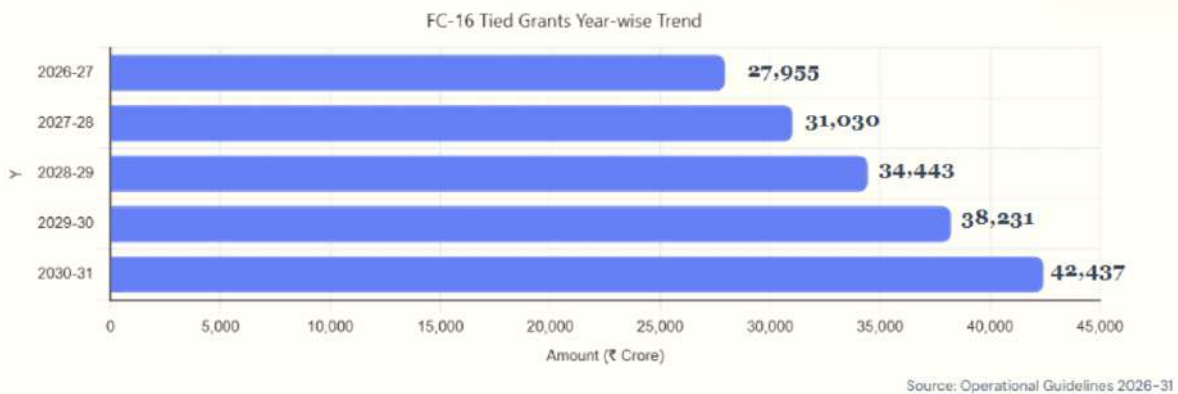


Figure :55 | Allocation of total tied grants under 16<sup>th</sup> FC-2026 to 2031 | Source: NJJM

### Governance as a Precondition for Funding

A key pillar of the framework is the emphasis on constitutional and institutional compliance. Grants are linked to the existence of duly constituted Rural Local Bodies as per constitutional provisions. States are also required to constitute State Finance Commissions every five years and place Action Taken Reports before the legislature within six months. Transparency is further reinforced through digital financial management systems. States must ensure availability of online provisional and audited accounts, and all financial and physical progress must be reported through platforms such as eGram Swaraj and PFMS.

Planning remains decentralised and participatory. Gram Sabhas, Block Panchayats, and District Panchayats are required to pass resolutions identifying activities under both tied and untied grants. These plans are to be integrated into GPDP, BPDP and DPDP and uploaded digitally, ensuring that investments are rooted in local priorities.

### Supporting Jal Jeevan Mission through Thematic Activities

A major strength of the guidelines is the explicit inclusion of thematic activities under Jal Jeevan Mission, ensuring that funding supports sustained functionality rather than just asset creation. The scope covers a wide range such as :

- Preventive maintenance and operational activities, including protection of drinking water sources, arrangements for alternate sources in case of failure, installation of chlorination systems, and minor repairs of pumps, pipelines, and control systems. Routine yet critical functions such as cleaning overhead tanks, maintaining water treatment plants, paying bulk water charges, and addressing emergency breakdowns are also supported, ensuring uninterrupted service delivery.
- The guidelines recognize the importance of water quality management, allowing expen-

diture on testing kits, reagents, and disinfectants such as bleaching powder and sodium hypochlorite.

- Equally important is the support for human resources, including operators, Jal Mitras, and community-level workers engaged in water testing and system management. Provision for honorarium and service charges ensures that village-level systems remain functional beyond commissioning.
- Further, the guidelines address recurring costs such as electricity charges and encourage the adoption of solar-powered systems, promoting long-term financial and environmental sustainability.
- The scope of support also extends to providing water access in public institutions schools, Anganwadi centres, health facilities, and community spaces ensuring inclusive service delivery.
- At the same time, emphasis is placed on community engage-

ment and behavior change, with support for IEC activities such as Jal Chaupal, water budgeting, awareness campaigns, and annual service assessments like Jal Seva Ankalan

- Administrative expenses related to planning, data management, and audits are also covered, strengthening local capacity.

### Integrating Sanitation: Thematic Activities under SBM G

Complementing JJM interventions, the guidelines also provide comprehensive support for Swachh Bharat Mission (Gramin) activities, promoting an integrated approach to water and sanitation.

- Under SBM G, tied grants support operation and maintenance of sanitation services, including honorarium for Swachhagrahis, minor repairs to community sanitation complexes, and upkeep of solid and liquid waste management assets.
- The guidelines also enable capacity building and IEC activities, including training of PRI members, VWSCs, and sanitation workers, as well as awareness campaigns on rural cleanliness and service delivery.
- Support for ODF sustainability and faecal sludge management includes construction of household and institutional toilets, retrofitting of sanitation systems, and development of FSM infrastructure.
- A wide range of solid waste management activities is covered, including compost pits, segregation sheds,

Gobardhan units, waste collection systems, and awareness campaigns on the 4Rs—reduce, reuse, recycle, and refuse.

- The guidelines also highlight grey water management, supporting drainage systems, soak pits, DEWATS, phytotrid systems, and household-level reuse practices such as kitchen gardens.

### Ensuring Financial Discipline and Accountability

To ensure effective utilisation of funds, the Commission has introduced clear and stringent financial norms. One of the key provisions is the 50% utilisation rule, under which States must certify that at least half of the previously released grants, both tied and untied, have been utilized before requesting the next instalment.

The guidelines also address the issue of unspent balances, which has often affected fund flow and efficiency. States must ensure that there are no unspent balances from the 14th Finance Commission or earlier periods before accessing new grants. For funds under the 15th Finance Commission, the norms become progressively stricter. From 2028–29 onwards, grants will not be released to Rural Local Bodies where unspent balances exceed 10% of the previous instalment, and in later years, eligibility will be restricted to those with no pending balances at all.

Additionally, States must submit consolidated utilisation reports to relevant ministries, ensuring alignment of expenditure with approved activities and strengthening transparency.

### Learning from Past Performance

The experience of the 15th Finance Commission provides encouraging evidence of improved fund utilisation. Of the total allocation of over ₹1.42 lakh crore, nearly ₹1.33 lakh crore (93.7%) has been released, reflecting strong implementation capacity across many States. The 16th Finance Commission builds on this progress, introducing tighter norms and clearer accountability mechanisms to further improve outcomes.

### Towards Sustainable, Community-Owned Systems

The 16th Finance Commission represents a significant shift in India's rural development approach moving from asset creation to sustainable service delivery systems.

By aligning financial resources with governance reforms, supporting operation and maintenance, promoting community participation, and integrating water and sanitation, the framework strengthens the ability of Panchayats to manage rural infrastructure effectively. For Jal Jeevan Mission, this convergence is particularly critical. It ensures that investments in rural water supply translate into reliable, safe, and continuous services, with communities at the centre of planning and management.

As rural India progresses towards long-term water security, the combined impact of Finance Commission grants and community-led approaches will play a defining role in building resilient, accountable, and sustainable water and sanitation systems for the future.



## Yamunanagar Achieves 100% Household Tap Connections: A Model for Sustainable Rural Water Supply

- Preeti, Director, Deputy Commissioner, Yamunanagar



Preeti

**Y**amunanagar district, located in the north-eastern part of Haryana, has a diverse geographical landscape, with

villages spread across plains, foothill areas and the Yamuna River belt. Due to its varied geography, ensuring safe and regular drinking water for every rural household was both important and challenging. The challenge went beyond providing tap connections; it also involved making the supply reliable, maintaining water quality and reducing dependence on ground-water sources.

In this context, Yamunanagar's achievement under the JJM stands as a significant example of focused planning, sustained effort, teamwork and community partici-

pation. What began as a mission to provide Functional Household Tap Connections gradually became a collective effort to improve the daily lives of rural families.

When the mission was launched in 2019, several villages in the district already had partial access to water supply. However, reaching every household with a functional tap connection remained a major task. Through consistent efforts by the district administration, engineers, field teams, Panchayati Raj Institutions and local communities, the coverage expanded step by step across villages and Gram



Figure :56 | Water testing at laboratory | Source: DWS, Yamunanagar

Panchayats. As a result, Yamunanagar achieved 100% coverage of Functional Household Tap Connections, covering 112,961 rural households across 601 villages and 471 Gram Panchayats. The district, with an approximate population of seven lakh, covers seven blocks, and around 3,009 projects have been completed with an expenditure of about ₹56 crore to ensure rural tap water supply coverage.

For the people of Yamunanagar, this achievement means much more than infrastructure. It has brought convenience, dignity, better health and greater assurance to rural households. Every tap connection represents reduced hardship, improved quality of life and a reliable service reaching families at their doorstep.

The district administration also understood that infrastructure alone would not be enough unless systems were created for long-term sustainability. Therefore, special emphasis was placed on operation and maintenance, community

ownership and local institutional strengthening. DWSM meetings are being conducted regularly, with focused discussions on the implementation of the O&M policy. Water and Sanitation Support Committees have been formed across the district, and capacity-building activities are being carried out to strengthen local institutions for managing water supply schemes.

To promote Panchayat-led management, meetings have been conducted with Panchayati Raj Institutions and village-level committees. As part of this process, 60 (MoU) Memorandums of Understanding have been signed between the Public Health Department and Gram Panchayats for the handover and management of water supply schemes. The district is also working to complete the remaining handover processes in a time-bound manner.

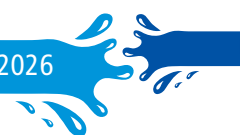
Community participation has been one of the strongest pillars of Yamunanagar's approach. Through Jal Chaupals, Panchayat-level

meetings, school programmes, small-group discussions and awareness campaigns, people have been encouraged to take ownership of water supply infrastructure. These initiatives are helping reduce water wastage, promote responsible water use and encourage regular service charge collection in villages. Over time, water supply has moved from being seen only as a government service to becoming a shared community responsibility.

Water quality monitoring has also remained a key focus area. The district has put systems in place for regular testing through the NABL-accredited Public Health Engineering District Water Testing Laboratory, along with field-level checks by trained community members. Self-Help Groups and Saksham Yuvas have been actively involved in household surveys and water testing using Field Testing Kits and OT Kits. Two to three samples are collected daily by Self-Help Groups, and a portion of these samples is also tested at the district laboratory for quality assurance. Chemical and



Figure :57 | Yamunanagar District participated in Amrut Mitra Mahotsav, New Delhi | Source: DWS, Yamunanagar



bacteriological testing is being carried out as per norms, including pre and post-monsoon testing of water sources.

Under the guidance of the District Administration, Self-Help Groups in Yamunanagar are also strengthening grassroots monitoring under the Jal Jeevan Mission. SHG members are conducting household surveys and ensuring real-time data entry on the BISWAS portal. They are also testing drinking water quality at the field level using OT kits. So far, Self-Help Groups have completed around 10,317 household surveys and conducted 528 OT tests. Their involvement has helped improve regular monitoring, support timely action and strengthen service delivery at the community level.

The role of Self-Help Groups has been especially important in strengthening water quality surveillance and community engagement. SHG members have been trained on water testing protocols, monitoring processes, complaint reporting and quality assurance. They are also being incentivized for their contribution at the grassroots level and are working closely with village-level

committees to build trust among communities.

The district has also taken strong steps to improve discipline and accountability in the water supply system. Special drives were conducted to identify and disconnect insanitary and unauthorized water connections. More than 1,200 such connections have been removed across urban and rural areas with the support of Panchayat-level committees. This initiative has helped improve hygiene, regulate water supply and reduce contamination risks.

Along with this, a responsive grievance redressal system has been established to ensure that issues are addressed quickly. While the Right to Service timeline allows two days for resolving maintenance-related complaints, the district is making efforts to resolve complaints within 24 hours wherever possible. Regular monitoring, timely repair of pipelines, motor and pump maintenance, disinfection of source water and round-the-clock complaint registration through grievance and receipt portals are helping ensure safe and reliable drinking water at the household level.

Regular review meetings at the district, sub-divisional and departmental levels have helped maintain momentum. Monthly reviews by the Deputy Commissioner through DWSM meetings ensure that field-level challenges are identified and addressed in time. Engineers, senior officers and field teams remain actively involved in monitoring the functionality of schemes and supporting communities in taking greater responsibility for rural water supply management.

Under Jal Seva Ankalan, more than 99% of Gram Panchayats have been covered. Based on village-level issues identified during the assessment, corrective action plans are being prepared and followed up to improve service delivery outcomes. This has helped the district move beyond coverage and focus on service quality, reliability and long-term sustainability.

The district has also linked water security with environmental responsibility. With the support of Self-Help Groups, around 1,000 trees have been planted by the Public Health Department, and SHG members will monitor their growth over the next year. This initiative



Figure :58 | O&M Policy 2026 for sustainable rural water supply management in Yamunanagar | Source: DWS, Yamunanagar



reflects Yamunanagar's effort to connect community participation with environmental sustainability.

As Yamunanagar looks ahead, the focus is now shifting from achieving coverage to sustaining reliable services. With the implementation of the O&M Policy 2026, greater responsibility is being entrusted to local communities, supported by transparent systems, user charge collection, accountability mechanisms and regular technical

support. The district is also exploring ways to link water management with livelihood opportunities, especially through Self-Help Groups, making the mission more meaningful for rural households.

In many ways, Yamunanagar's journey is about more than water. It is a story of what can be achieved when administration, communities and local institutions work together with a shared purpose. Every tap connection in the district tells a

story of improved lives, reduced hardships and stronger dignity. As the district moves forward, its experience serves as a reminder that real change becomes sustainable when people are placed at the centre of every effort. In Yamunanagar, that change is now flowing into every rural home.

*-Copy edited by  
Aniketa Sattavan*



# Transforming Rural Water Security in Sepahijala: From Har Ghar Jal to Har Din Jal

- Dr. Siddharth Shiv Jaiswal, IAS, District Magistrate & Collector Sepahijala District, Tripura



**Dr. Siddharth Shiv Jaiswal**

*"The recognition received under the 6th National Water Awards reflects our belief that sustainable water sources are the foundation of sustainable drinking water services"*

## A Mission Beyond Infrastructure

Access to safe drinking water is not merely an infrastructure objective, it is a matter of dignity, health, social equity and human development. The Jal Jeevan Mission has provided us with a unique opportunity to transform the lives of rural households by ensuring that every family receives potable water through a functional household tap connection. In Sepahijala District, we have embraced this mission not only as a government programme but as a people's movement driven by the community participation and collective responsibility.

Sepahijala district has achieved substantial progress under Jal Jeevan Mission. Out of 1.17 lakh rural households, more than 1.01 lakh households have already been provided with Functional Household Tap Connections, taking the district's overall coverage to over 86%. Twenty villages have attained Har Ghar Jal status, reflecting steady march towards universal coverage.

## Inclusive Development Through DAJGUA and PM JANMAN

A key focus area of Jal Jeevan Mission implementation in Sepahijala District has been the saturation of drinking water services in tribal and vulnera-

ble habitations covered under Government of India flagship initiatives.

Under the Dharti Aaba Janjatiya Gram Utkarsh Abhiyan (DAJGUA), the district has achieved 82.64 % Functional Household Tap Connection (FHTC) coverage. The programme seeks to bridge critical infrastructure gaps in tribal-majority villages through a convergent and mission-mode approach. The progress achieved under Jal Jeevan Mission reflects the commitment to ensuring that tribal communities receive equitable access to safe and adequate drinking water services.

Similarly, under Pradhan Mantri Janjati Adivasi Nyaya Maha Abhiyan (PM JANMAN), which focuses on the socio-economic development of



Figure :59 | AS&MD NJJM interacting with district administrations in 9<sup>th</sup> DCPS | Source: DWSM, Sepahijala

Particularly Vulnerable Tribal Groups (PVTGs), Sepahijala district has achieved 74.29% household tap water coverage. The progress achieved under PM JANMAN demonstrates the district's determination to reach the last mile and ensure that the benefits of development extend to every eligible household.

These achievements reaffirm the guiding principle of Jal Jeevan Mission-no household should be left behind. Through sustained field monitoring, community participation and convergence among departments, the district is working towards achieving universal coverage across all DAJGUA and PM JANMAN habitations.

### Strengthening Implementation Through Effective Governance

These achievements have been possible because of the coordinated efforts of engineers, field functionaries, Panchayati Raj Institutions, Village Water and Sanitation Committees, elected representatives and community members. Regular monitoring through District Water and Sanitation Mission meetings, continuous field inspections and third-party quality assessments have ensured transparency and accountability in implementation. The satisfactory findings of the recent audit conducted by the Ministry of Jal Shakti further reinforce district commitment towards maintaining high standards of execution and service delivery

### Ensuring Sustainability of Water Sources

While the creation of water supply infrastructure is essential, ensuring its long-term sustainability remains

the highest priority. Water security cannot be achieved through pipelines alone; it requires effective conservation, groundwater recharge, and responsible management of available water resources.

The sustained commitment of Sepahijala District towards sustainable water resource management has been nationally recognized through the 6th National Water Awards, one of the country's most prestigious recognitions in the water sector. This achievement reflects the district's continuous efforts in groundwater recharge, source sustainability, rainwater harvesting, wetland restoration, and community-driven water management initiatives.

The district has adopted a proactive and integrated approach to safeguard drinking water sources for future generations. Several groundwater recharge structures, including injection wells, have been developed across the district to enhance groundwater availability and strengthen resilience against seasonal water stress. These interventions have been implemented through convergence with various government programmes and active participation of local communities.

Under the Jal Shakti Abhiyan, Sepahijala District has achieved significant progress in groundwater recharge and water conservation. A total of 42 water bodies were rejuvenated, while the Rudrasagar Ramsar Wetland (2.4 sq. km) underwent extensive hydrological restoration, desiltation, cleaning, and de-weeding through convergence of MGNREGA and 15th Finance Commission Grants.

The district has also promoted efficient water use in agriculture by expanding micro-irrigation coverage to 832 hectares, including an additional 60 hectares during FY 2024-25. Water conservation efforts were further strengthened through

the excavation of ponds and construction of check dams, creating a cumulative water storage capacity of approximately 9.09 lakh cubic metres. Additionally, 820 soak pits, 300 dug wells, and several hundred micro water storage structures were developed across the district, substantially enhancing groundwater recharge and improving local water security.

This national recognition serves as an inspiration to further strengthen efforts towards sustainable water management. It highlights that while household tap connections are critical for improving access to drinking water, ensuring the sustainability of water sources is equally important for delivering reliable and uninterrupted services in the future. This achievement belongs to the people of Sepahijala, whose active participation, awareness, and commitment to water conservation have played a pivotal role in establishing the district as a model for sustainable water resource management.

### Water Quality Surveillance and Monitoring: Ensuring Safe Drinking Water for All

Providing safe, potable, and quality drinking water to the people of Sepahijala District and the State remains the foremost priority of the District Administration and the Drinking Water & Sanitation Department. To ensure that every citizen receives water that meets prescribed quality standards, a comprehensive water quality surveillance and monitoring system has been established across the district.

The district follows a systematic and scientific approach to water quality monitoring. For all surface water sources, both chemical and bacteriological analyses are conducted on a



quarterly basis to assess the suitability of water for human consumption. In addition, water samples from key delivery points such as schools and Anganwadi Centres (AWCs) are tested every quarter to ensure that children and other beneficiaries receive safe drinking water.

At the household level, regular surveillance is undertaken through the collection and testing of water samples, with two household samples per village being tested every month. This enables continuous monitoring of water quality at the consumer end and helps identify any emerging issues in the distribution system.

For groundwater sources, water quality assessments are conducted twice a year through pre-monsoon and post-monsoon testing, allowing the district to evaluate seasonal variations in groundwater quality and take timely corrective measures where necessary.

The monitoring programme includes testing for critical water quality parameters such as Free Residual Chlorine (FRC), Turbidity, E. coli, and Total Coliform bacteria. These tests are carried out through both laboratory analysis and the use of Field Testing Kits (FTKs), ensuring wider coverage and prompt detection of any contamination.

The district has demonstrated a strong commitment to water quality surveillance through extensive testing activities. During FY 2024–25, a total of 9,372 water quality tests were conducted. In FY 2025–26, 4,839 laboratory-based tests were carried out, while 1,178 laboratory tests have already been completed in FY 2026–27 up to the current period.

Community participation has also been strengthened through the use of Field Testing Kits. During FY 2025–26, 5,065 FTK-based tests were conducted, and 1,222 FTK tests have been carried out so far in FY 2026–27.

These efforts have enabled timely monitoring of drinking water quality at the grassroots level and enhanced community awareness regarding safe water practices.

Through regular surveillance, scientific testing protocols, and active community involvement, Sepahijala District continues to strengthen its water quality management framework, ensuring that safe and reliable drinking water reaches every household, institution, and community across the district.

### Community at the Centre: Jal Seva Aankalan

The introduction of Jal Seva Aankalan marks a significant shift toward community driven water governance, placing citizens at the core of service delivery. Through this framework, Gram Panchayats and Village Water and Sanitation Committees are now able to assess not only water availability but also the quality, reliability, and long term sustainability of the services provided.

The assessment has brought to light several operational challenges, such as pipeline leakages, frequent power

interruptions, and the need for more robust arrangements to finance operation and maintenance activities. Rather than being viewed as obstacles, these insights offer a clear pathway for strengthening service delivery. In response, District Technical Units have been formed, and targeted action plans are now being implemented to enhance institutional capacity, streamline maintenance processes, ensure timely repairs, and promote greater community involvement in managing water systems.

### Building Ownership Through IEC and Capacity Development

Community ownership remains the cornerstone of the Jal Jeevan Mission. Through extensive IEC activities, awareness campaigns, school outreach programmes, wall paintings, street plays and village-level interactions, we have worked to build awareness regarding water conservation, hygiene and responsible use of drinking water infrastructure. The training of women in Field Test Kit usage has further strength-



Figure :60 | Jal Seva Aankalan at Bagber GP | Source: DWSM, Sepahijala



Figure :61 | Jal Seva Aankalan at Kalshimura GP | Source: DWSM, Sepahijala



Figure :62 | Women's Day Celebration | Source: DWSM, Sepahijala



Figure :63 | Plumbers Day Celebration | Source: DWSM, Sepahijala

ened local participation in water quality surveillance and empowered communities to become active custodians of their water systems.

The celebration of Jal Arpan Diwas and Jal Mahotsav in various villages of the district has been particularly inspiring. These events symbolize the transition from government-owned infrastructure to community-owned assets. They remind us that the success of Jal Jeevan Mission ultimately depends upon the willingness of communities to protect, maintain and sustain the systems that have been created for their benefit.

## Way Forward

As we move forward, the focus will remain on achieving 100 percent Functional Household Tap Connection coverage by March 2027 while simultaneously ensuring sustainability, functionality and quality of service. The district goal is not only to achieve Har Ghar Jal but to ensure Har Din Jal—safe, reliable and adequate drinking water every day for every household.

- Copy edited by Lopamudra Panda,  
NPMU-NJIM



## Sivasagar: Redefining Sustainability of Rural Water Supply

– Mridul Yadav, Deputy Commissioner, Sivasagar, Assam



Mridul Yadav

**A**cross rural India, the Jal Jeevan Mission has brought tap water closer to millions of households. As the mission moves beyond infrastructure creation, the focus is now on sustaining these systems through community ownership, regular operation and maintenance. Sivasagar district in Assam reflects this shift strongly. With 76% of its Piped Water Supply Schemes actively collecting tariffs, compared to the Assam average of 28%, the district ranks among the highest-performing districts in the state. This progress shows how sustained governance, community participation and regular monitoring can turn water supply infrastructure into a reliable village-level service.

Sivasagar's progress has been supported by a strong district-level review and coordination mechanism. The District Water and Sanitation Mission (DWSM) conducts regular meetings to monitor the progress of

water supply schemes, review field-level challenges and ensure timely follow-up. The minutes of these meetings are uploaded on the national JJM Integrated Management Information System (IMIS) portal, strengthening transparency and accountability. Water supply-related issues are also taken up during District Development Committee (DDC) meetings, which help in better coordination among departments and faster resolution of operational challenges.

A key strength of Sivasagar's approach is the structured pre-commissioning verification process. No completed water supply scheme is declared operational until it undergoes mandatory joint inspection involving senior district officials, Third Party Inspection Agencies (TPIAs), PHED engineers and representatives from concerned departments.

Following technical approval, the scheme enters the community handover phase. Water User Committees (WUCs) jointly inspect the infrastructure with PHED officials to verify whether the system meets local expectations. If concerns are raised, handover is delayed until corrective measures are completed. This ensures that infrastructure acceptance is based not only on engineering standards but also on community satisfaction. The final transfer of assets is conducted in the presence of community members, elected representatives, district officials and line departments. The process is further strengthened through Gaon Sabha approval, ensuring collective ownership among beneficiaries and Panchayati Raj Institution representatives.

A major challenge in rural infrastructure management is the gap created by departmental boundaries. A



Figure :64 | Regular DWSM meetings were conducted to review progress and ensure timely follow-up, | Source: DWS, Sivasagar



Figure :65 | Review of scheme functionality by the Additional Chief Engineer, PHE, with AEEs, SOs and field staff | Source: DWS, Shivsagar



Figure :66 | Meeting with Tea Garden Management's on Handing Over of Tea Garden Water Supply | Source: DWS, Shivsagar

technical failure, such as a power disruption affecting a water pump, can leave communities without water if coordination mechanisms are weak. Sivasagar addressed this challenge through strong institu-

tional convergence. The district established a coordinated field governance system involving the CEO, PHED Executive Engineer, and Block Development Officers (BDOs). Monthly joint field reviews assess the

functionality of schemes and address operational challenges.

This coordination has enabled effective use of resources, including the deployment of 15th Finance Commission grants for minor repairs across 56 water supply schemes. Similarly, decisions taken through DWSM mechanisms helped ensure quick restoration of electricity supply to water schemes during disruptions. Coordination with other departments also helped protect pipelines during road expansion and infrastructure projects.

The district has extended this institutional collaboration to tea garden communities by partnering with Tea Garden Associations to support management, protection, and sustainable operation of schemes serving these areas.

Sivasagar understands that long-term sustainability of water supply systems depends on trained local people. To build this capacity, the district has trained Jal Mitras and local operators in partnership with Industrial Training Institutes (ITIs). These trainings focus on practical skills such as plumbing, machine maintenance, valve operation and digital monitoring. Field staffs have also been trained in High-Density Polyethylene (HDPE) pipe jointing, which has reduced dependence on external contractors and enabled



Figure :67 | Training of Jal Mitras at ITIs and hands-on training in HDPE pipe jointing | Source: DWS, Shivsagar



local teams to respond quickly to leakages and other technical issues.

This capacity building is supported by strong monitoring systems. Officials conduct village-level engagement with Water User Committees, while monthly reviews track tariff collection, service delivery, and community participation. Field operators also conduct “Tail-End Flow Checks” to ensure that households located at the farthest points of distribution networks receive adequate water supply.

Water availability alone is not sufficient; quality assurance remains essential. Sivasagar has developed a community-based monitoring system combining scientific testing with grassroots participation. Dedicated five-member women Field Test Kit (FTK) groups in every village conduct regular water quality testing with support from Jal Mitras. Their findings are verified through District and Sub-Divisional Laboratories, ensuring reliable monitoring of certified Har Ghar Jal villages.

To build public confidence, water quality reports and test results are displayed at community locations. This transparency has strengthened trust and encouraged communities to support regular tariff payments.

### The success of Sivasagar is also reflected through these community-oriented innovations

Baruah Pukhuri PWSS— Changing Behaviour through Communication: When some households resisted tariff payments, targeted door-to-door awareness campaigns addressed misconceptions and highlighted the importance of community ownership. The initiative achieved 100% tariff collection,

cleared pending electricity dues, and created maintenance reserves.

Saraihajia PWSS— Overcoming Geographical Challenges: Located near the Assam-Nagaland border, the scheme serves a community that previously faced water scarcity due to difficult terrain and low groundwater availability. Despite challenges, the community achieved complete tariff collection, demonstrating that ownership grows when people value the service.

KhataPathar New PWSS— Women-led Water Governance: Sivasagar’s first all-women Water User Committee manages this scheme with support from Self-Help Groups (SHGs). The model introduced collection incentives and created a permanent repair reserve, demonstrating the role of women’s leadership in water management.

ChangmaiSasonial PWSS— Digital Transformation: By introducing QR-based payments and digital collection systems, the scheme eliminated revenue leakages and achieved full tariff collection, generating surplus funds for maintenance and performance incentives.

Hatimuria Gharphalia PWSS— Water as a Social Asset: With strong financial management, the Water User Committee built a significant reserve fund. The surplus was used for community welfare activities, including distribution of water storage tanks and student scholarships. The scheme’s conservation initiatives also received national recognition.

Kathalbari PWSS— Leadership at the Grassroots: Jal Mitra Bablu

Phukan demonstrated how individual commitment can strengthen public systems. Through active community engagement and efficient management, the scheme developed financial reserves, maintained infrastructure, and supported digital monitoring.

The impact of these efforts is also visible in public health outcomes. At Dikhowmukh, an initiative connecting water security with health awareness through Village Health Sanitation Committees helped reduce diarrhoeal cases and strengthen community hygiene practices.

The Sivasagar model highlights key lessons for sustaining rural water supply systems. It shows that strong administrative mechanisms are necessary to keep public infrastructure functional overtime.

By making water supply reviews part of regular governance processes, the district ensures that operational issues are identified and addressed without delay. The model also underlines the importance of financial independence for community ownership. With digital tools, transparent systems and local partnerships, Water User Committees are able to move beyond the role of beneficiaries and function as responsible institutions managing their own resources.

At the same time, Sivasagar’s experience shows that behaviour change is essential for sustainability. Community resistance can be addressed more effectively through dialogue, awareness and participation rather than enforcement. When people develop a sense of ownership, infrastructure becomes a shared community responsibility.

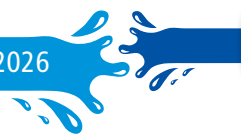
Looking ahead, Sivasagar aims to extend these practices to all



Figure :68 | Changmai Sasonial PWSS, (inset – QR of the WUC, enabling digitization of tariff Collection) | Source: DWSM Gangtok

remaining water supply schemes. The district will continue to focus on regular tariff collection, trained local teams and stronger community participation. Its experience shows that sustainable rural water supply depends not only on infrastructure, but also on good governance and people's ownership.

-Copy edited by  
Aniketa Sattavan



# Jal Jeevan Mission in Ayodhya – From Access to Assured Har Ghar Jal

– Shashank Tripathi, District Magistrate, Ayodhya, Uttar Pradesh



**Shashank Tripathi**

## Introduction

Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) is a flagship programme launched by the Government of India in 2019 to provide safe and adequate drinking water to all rural households. A key component of the Mission is the “Har Ghar Jal” initiative, which aims to ensure that every rural home has a Functional Household Tap Connection (FHTC). The Mission is implemented by the Ministry of Jal Shakti in partnership with State Governments and local communities.

The District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad is a structured review dialogue initiated by NJJM in which the District

Magistrate, implementing engineers, third-party inspection agencies and community institutions come together to take stock of drinking-water progress and to resolve field-level bottlenecks. On 16 June 2026, the District Administration of Ayodhya convened the 9<sup>th</sup> edition of this Samvad under the chairmanship of the District Magistrate & Collector, Shri Shashank Tripathi.

The Samvad reviewed the district's advance towards the Government of India goal of a functional tap connection in every rural home and reaffirmed the district's resolve to complete all remaining schemes in a time-bound manner.

## District at a Glance

Ayodhya's rural drinking-water programme spans a large and dispersed geography. The district covers 535 schemes across 772 Gram Panchayats and 1,144 revenue villages, with a targeted 3,33,584 Functional Household Tap Connections. Implementation is delivered through four EPC agencies, supported by a construction-stage Third-Party Inspection Agency (TPIA) and a dedicated Operation & Maintenance (O&M) TPI.

## DWSM Monitoring & Implementation

The district has put in place a layered



Figure :69 | The District Magistrate chairing DWSM meeting | Source: DWSM Ayodhya

|                                  |                                     |                                  |                                    |
|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <b>535</b><br>Schemes            | <b>772</b><br>Gram Panchayats       | <b>1,144</b><br>Revenue Villages | <b>3,33,584</b><br>Targeted FHTC   |
| <b>3,27,962</b><br>FHTC Provided | <b>336</b><br>Schemes 100% Complete | <b>99%</b><br>Road Restoration   | <b>04</b><br>Implementing Agencies |

oversight system to ensure that schemes are completed in a time-bound manner and to a verifiable standard. The Samvad reviewed the pillars of this monitoring framework.

- ◆ **District-level oversight**-The District Water & Sanitation Committee (DWSC), chaired by the District Magistrate, drives time-bound and quality completion of works.
- ◆ **Three-tier inspection**-Field engineers, the TPIA and the District Programme Management Unit (DPMU) verify works at every stage of construction.
- ◆ **Convergence & clearances**- Land acquisition, NOC approvals and inter-departmental coordination are expedited so that schemes are not held up by external dependencies.
- ◆ **Portal-based tracking**- Stage-wise progress is monitored on the JJM portal, and works are treated as complete only after portal verification. expedited so that schemes are not held up by external dependencies.

## Har Ghar Jal & Regular Water Supply

Delivery of assured, regular supply to households is the central measure of the Mission. As reported at the Samvad, 337 schemes have been completed and 3,27,962 FHTCs provided (as per portal data). Regular supply has been extended across a growing footprint of villages, with road restoration treated as a completion gate rather than an afterthought.



Figure :70 | Solar-powered overhead tank and water supply scheme delivering regular supply to a village | Source: DWSC Ayodhya

## Source Sustainability & Water Quality

Long-term reliability of supply depends on both the health of the source and the safety of the water delivered. The district's approach, as presented at the Samvad, rests on four measures.

- ◆ **Recharge structures** - Recharge structures have been developed on JJM schemes to support the water table, complemented by plantation drives with the Forest Department.
- ◆ **Water-quality testing** - Source and supply water is tested through the

|                                                                                                                                                                       |                                         |                                          |                                               |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| <b>337</b><br>Schemes Completed                                                                                                                                       | <b>378</b><br>Schemes on Regular Supply | <b>762</b><br>Villages on Regular Supply | <b>495</b><br>Schemes — 100% Road Restoration |
| Road restoration is complete on 495 schemes (93%). For the remaining schemes, Har Ghar Jal certification and regular supply are being pursued in a time-bound manner. |                                         |                                          |                                               |





Figure :71 | Recharge structures developed under JJM | Source: DWSM Ayodhya

district laboratory and Field Testing Kits (FTKs); women have been trained to carry out field testing.

- 💧 **Chlorinated safe supply** - Chlorination and silver-ionisation systems are operated on schemes to ensure safe drinking water.
- 💧 **Source Sustainability Plan** - SSP documentation is maintained at scheme and district level in line with GEC-2015 and CGWB norms.

### Best Practice: Ayodhya Skill Development Centre, Rudauli

A defining highlight of the Samvad was Ayodhya's skill-development initiative — Uttar Pradesh's first such centre, established in Vikas Khand Rudauli. The centre builds a trained, local workforce for the construction and operation of water-supply assets and has already extended its reach to neighbouring districts.

|                               |                        |                               |                               |
|-------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| <b>22</b><br>Training Batches | <b>25</b><br>Per Batch | <b>550</b><br>Workmen Trained | <b>03</b><br>Districts Served |
|-------------------------------|------------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|

#### Skill Centre — Training Coverage

**Trades:** Fitters, Plumbers, Masons and Operators

**Core modules:** Pipe fitting & alignment; plumbing & leak prevention; masonry for OHTs, chambers and structures; safety with PPE for height & excavation; quality workmanship & standards; basic O&M awareness

**On-site training:** Second skill centre at Muzaffarpur WSS enables hands-on, on-site training

**Digital operations:** Operators additionally trained in SCADA and solar-system basics



Figure :72 | Digital operations: Operators additionally trained in SCADA and solar-system basics | Source: DWSM Ayodhya



Figure :73 | Trainees at the Rudauli Skill Development Centre during a hands-on plumbing and fitting session | Source: DWSM Ayodhya

## From Training to Transformation: Impact

The investment in skilling is translating into measurable improvements on the ground. The Samvad recorded the following outcomes.

- 💧 **Improved quality of work** - Proper jointing has cut leakage, masonry finish has improved, and installation has been standardised.
- 💧 **Enhanced safety performance** - Higher PPE use and fewer unsafe acts in lifting, shuttering and scaffolding.
- 💧 **Local skilled workforce** - Reduced dependence on outside labour, with trained manpower now available locally.
- 💧 **Faster project execution** - Less rework from better workmanship and improved coordination between trades.
- 💧 **Digital & sustainable operations** - SCADA- and solar-trained operators enable modern plant operation.





The impact on Operation & Maintenance is significant: reduced leakage lowers maintenance cost, correct slope improves water flow, durable construction extends asset life, and defects are identified earlier. Together these gains directly advance the Mission's goal of sustainable, reliable supply to every household.

## Women Empowerment under JJM

The Mission has placed women at the centre of water governance, building a stronger, more equal and water-secure society. The measures presented include the training of five women as Jal Sakhis in every Gram Panchayat to carry out water-quality testing using FTK kits, and the active

role of women in Village Water & Sanitation Committees (VWSCs) and Pani Samitis, where they drive O&M decisions. With tap connections at home, hours saved each day are being redirected to livelihoods and education, while Self-Help Groups and women plumbers are engaged in tariff collection and scheme operation.



Figure :74 | A trained Jal Sakhi conducting a field water-quality test using an FTK; a woman operator at the SCADA panel | Source: DWSM Ayodhya

## Jan Shikayat Nivaran — Grievance Redressal

A responsive, multi-channel grievance system supports the programme. Complaints can be lodged through the Jal Saarathi App (a dedicated JJM complaint channel), the CM Helpline (1076), the SWSM toll-free number (1800-121-2164), and the JJM portal at [jjm.up.gov.in](http://jjm.up.gov.in). Under this integrated redressal system, complaints received through these channels are resolved each month within timelines, with quality monitored at the district level. On the portal, a complainant logs the issue, which is auto routed to the Junior Engineer or Assistant Engineer for field action, and the case is closed only after the complainant confirms resolution.

### Jal Saarathi App

Dedicated JJM Channel

### 1076

CM Helpline

### 1800-121-2164

SWSM Toll-free

## Jal Arpan — Scheme Handover to Gram Panchayat

Sustaining the schemes over the long term depends on genuine community ownership. Under Jal Arpan, completed schemes are formally handed over to Gram Panchayats along with the responsibility for their operation — the moment a village declares the water system its own and pledges to sustain it. Of 336 schemes identified for handover, 109 have been handed over to Gram Panchayats, leaving a balance of 227.

### Jal Arpan & Functionality Assessment — Status

**Total schemes for handover:** 336

**Handed over (Jal Arpan):** 109

**Balance:** 227

**Jal Seva Aankalan:** 353 of 363 Gram Panchayats assessed; DTU review complete for 353 GPs

**Nature:** Gram-Sabha-verified, community-based functionality self-assessment — a Government of India



Figure :75 | Jal Arpan handover ceremony — a completed scheme entrusted to the Gram Panchayat and community | Source: DWSM Ayodhya





Figure :76 | Jal Arpan handover ceremony – a completed scheme entrusted to the Gram Panchayat and community | Source: DWSM Ayodhya

## Impact Assessment — KGMU, Lucknow

An independent impact assessment carried out by King George's Medical University (KGMU), Lucknow, corroborated the social gains of the programme. Piped supply at home has freed women from fetching water over long distances, saving significant time. Safe, chlorinated supply has reduced water-borne illness in the surveyed villages, and communities have become active partners in water conservation and O&M. Reliable water has also supported school attendance and local employment, reinforcing the wider development dividend of the Mission.

## Way Forward

The Samvad closed with a clear, four-point agenda for the remaining period.

- ◆ 1-Har Ghar Jal certification gap closure.
- ◆ 2-SCADA / tube-well automation rollout.
- ◆ 3-Expansion of O&M and skilling.
- ◆ 4-Time-bound completion of all remaining schemes.

Ayodhya's resolve is to deliver a trained local workforce, an automated and chlorinated supply, and

certified Har Ghar Jal — sustainable water for every household.

## Conclusion

The 9<sup>th</sup> District Collectors' Peyjal Samvad marked an important step in strengthening grassroots engagement under Jal Jeevan Mission in Ayodhya. It fostered a shared understanding among community members, Panchayati Raj Institutions and implementing agencies of their roles in ensuring safe, adequate and regular drinking-water supply to every household.

Emphasis was laid on water-quality

monitoring, source sustainability, a skilled local workforce, operation and maintenance, and active community participation. With continued convergence and deepening community ownership through VWSCs and Jal Sakhis, and with the district's first-of-its-kind skill centre at Rudauli anchoring quality on the ground, Ayodhya is well-positioned to fulfil the vision of “Har Ghar Jal” for every one of its residents.

- Copy edited by Lopamudra Panda,  
NPMU-NJIM





# Redefining Sustainability of Rural Drinking Water Supply in Una

- Jatin Lal, Deputy Commissioner, Una, Himachal Pradesh



Jatin Lal

Across rural India, Jal Jeevan Mission has moved from infrastructure creation to sustained service delivery. District Una presents a strong Himachal Pradesh example where universal household tap coverage is being supported by water quality surveillance, community participation, Panchayat involvement, technical strengthening and digital governance.

Una has achieved a major milestone by providing Functional Household Tap Connections to all rural households and obtaining Har Ghar Jal certification from villages and Gram Panchayats. The district is now consolidating functionality through water testing, trained local operators,

community awareness, source sustainability and scheme-level monitoring.

The district context is technically demanding. Hilly pockets, scattered habitations, long distribution networks, high dependence on

pumping, low-voltage issues, old pipelines and monsoon damage require a governance model that is both engineering-driven and community-centred. Una has responded through augmentation of old schemes, strengthening of rising mains and storage, field-level quality



Figure : 77 | District Una map and administrative divisions | Source: Source: DWSM Una

**6.24 lakh**  
Population

**1,14,209**  
Rural households

**742**  
Villages

**235**  
Water supply schemes

**1 + 2**  
NABL accredited / recognized labs

testing and active public engagement.

### Core message

- Universal tap coverage has been achieved; the district is now strengthening dependable water at the household tap.
- A large infrastructure base of

water supply schemes, tubewells, borewells, pump rooms, GSRs and OHTs is being operated through Jal Shakti field systems.

- Women-led FTK testing, Gram Sabha engagement, VWSC strengthening and Panchayat handover have converted

beneficiaries into local water-system partners.

- Digital asset registry, SCADA/OTR monitoring, Sujal Gaon App and GIS-linked monitoring are helping Una move towards a service-oriented water utility model.



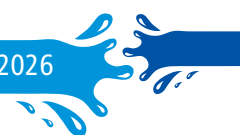
Figure :78 | Nari Neer Shakti Diwas under Jal Mahotsav 2026: women as central stakeholders in water governance | Source: DWSM Una

## District Context and Water Supply Baseline

Una district has a population of about 6.24 lakh, with around 5.54 lakh people living in rural areas. The district covers 1549 sq. km. and has five development blocks. Drinking water supply planning has to serve both settled plains and hilly pockets where scattered habitations require longer alignments and higher pumping effort.

Under JJM, Una covered 1,14,209 rural households. At the launch of JJM, 79,350 households already had FHTCs. The remaining 34,859 households were provided tap connections under the Mission. All 742 villages have been reported as Har Ghar Jal villages, indicating universal household tap water coverage.

| Indicator          | Una district status                     |
|--------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| Population         | 6,24,222                                |
| Rural population   | 5,53,725                                |
| Urban population   | 69,498                                  |
| Literacy rate      | 86.53%                                  |
| Area               | 1549 sq. km.                            |
| Coverage under JJM | 1,14,209 rural households; 742 villages |



## Infrastructure base

The district water supply network consists of 235 water supply schemes supported by 248 tubewells, 1,210 borewells, 54 dugwells, 276 pump rooms, 620 Ground Storage Reservoirs and 237 Overhead Tanks. This large asset base is supported by one NABL-accredited district-level laboratory and two NABL-recognized sub-divisional laboratories



## From Infrastructure Creation to Service Delivery

Prior to JJM augmentation, various schemes faced inadequate storage capacity, frequent leakages in rising mains and distribution systems, declining source discharge and ageing conveyance infrastructure. JJM interventions in Una have

addressed these gaps through new storage tanks, pumping stations, source sustainability measures, strengthening of rising mains and improvement of distribution reliability.

Revival and augmentation works have addressed problems in schemes such as WSS Behdala, WSS Nangran,

WSS Kuriala, WSS Nari, WSS Basal, WSS Jhalera, WSS Dangoli, WSS Rainsari and WSS Madanpur. The work has improved storage, pumping efficiency, leakage control and supply reliability for beneficiary households.



Figure :79 | Revived water supply infrastructure: new/strengthened pump room and storage arrangement | Source: DWSM Una

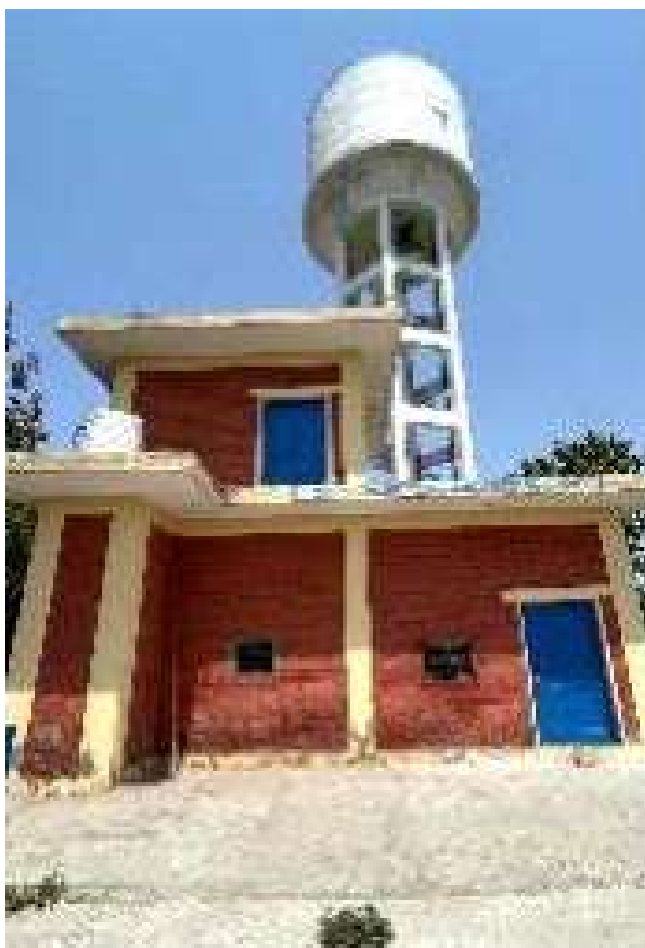


Figure :80 | Overhead tank and pump house strengthening under JJM-related works | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :81 | Pumping machinery supporting improved lifting and distribution efficiency | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :82 | NABL laboratory infrastructure for scientific water quality verification | Source: DWSM Una

### Service delivery gains visible on ground

- ◆ New and strengthened storage tanks have improved balancing capacity and helped stabilize supply in distribution zones.
- ◆ Pumping stations and machinery have improved lifting and distribution efficiency in high-dependence pumping schemes.
- ◆ Repairing and strengthening of rising mains and distribution systems has reduced leakage-prone stretches and improved reliability.
- ◆ Laboratory support has added scientific validation to drinking water quality surveillance.

### Community Ownership and Jal Bandhan

Sustainability of rural drinking water systems cannot remain only a departmental responsibility. Una has taken a community-participation approach by handing over distribution systems of several drinking water schemes to Gram Panchayats across Amb, Gagret, Bangana, Haroli and Una blocks.

Schemes handed over include Suri and Salana Maslana in Amb Block; Amboa and Babehar in Gagret Block; Dhundla Lift Water Supply Scheme and Tanoh Dadeta in Bangana Block; Bathu, Haroli, Hiran Nagar, Hira Thada, Dharampur, Kangar, Bareda, Lower Bareda, Panjawar and Lower

Panjawar in Haroli Block; and Madanpur, Nari, Chalola, Police Line, Rampur, Jalgran Tabba, Durga Shiva Dharmani Colony, Rakkar, Jalgran Green Avenue Colony and Nangra in Una Block.

During Jal Mahotsav, Jal Bandhan and Jal Sankalp activities connected citizens emotionally with water assets. In Una, local water assets such as Samoor Dam and Chaplah Dam also communicate the importance of source protection, storage, recharge and community responsibility.



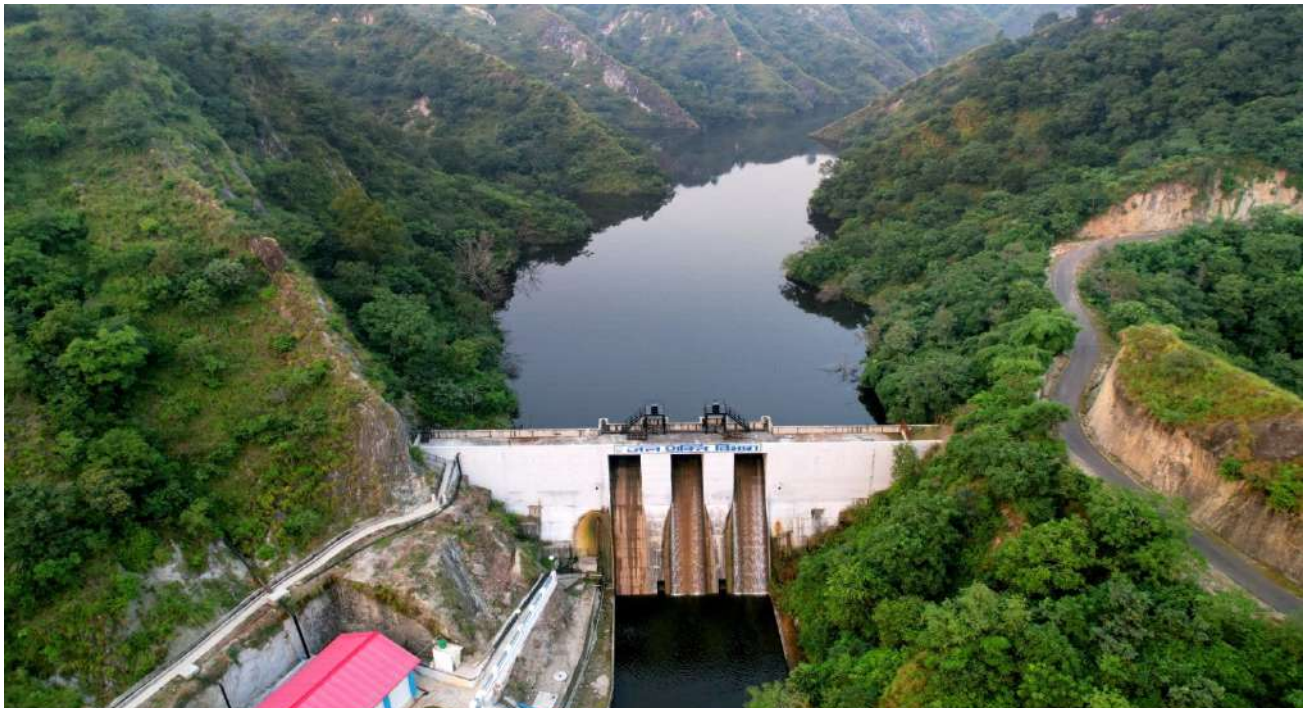


Figure :83 | Jal Bandhan: Samoor Dam as a local water asset linked with conservation and source responsibility | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :84 | Jal Bandhan: Chaplah Dam reflecting water storage, protection and community awareness | Source: DWSM Una

### Achievements through community handover

- Distribution systems of several schemes have been handed over to Gram Panchayats, making local institutions partners in operation and reporting.
- Special Gram Sabha meetings have been conducted across Gram Panchayats to explain the

objectives of Jal Jeevan Mission and strengthen public ownership.

- PRI representatives, VWSC members, school teachers, Anganwadi workers and women community members have been trained through CCDU and other capacity-building platforms.
- Jal Arpan Diwas, Jal Bandhan, Jal

Sankalp, Jal Vandana and Jal Shringar activities have built a culture of respect for public water infrastructure.

### Water Quality Assurance: From Laboratory to Village

Una has placed strong emphasis on drinking water quality monitoring. Testing is carried out through one NABL-accredited district-level labora-



Figure :85 | District-level and sub-divisional laboratory support for quality assurance | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :86 | Water quality testing by trained women as part of community surveillance | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :87 | School-based awareness and practical water quality demonstration | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :88 | Women and community members participating in awareness activities | Source: DWSM Una

tory and two NABL-recognized sub-divisional laboratories. At the field level, FTK-based testing is carried out in Anganwadi Centres, schools and villages.

The district has trained five women from each of 742 villages in the use of Field Testing Kits. Panchayati Raj representatives, Rural Water and Sanitation Committees, Anganwadi workers and women community members have also been trained. This converts water quality surveillance from a purely departmental activity into a community-based public health safeguard.

Technology has also been introduced in water quality assurance.

Hypochlorinators, Online Turbidity Residual monitoring systems and SCADA systems are being used in many schemes. These systems track residual chlorine, turbidity and operational parameters, while laboratory verification gives scientific credibility to village-level testing.

### Public confidence measures adopted

- FTK testing has been taken to all 1,316 Anganwadi Centres and 842 schools across the district.
- Drinking water sources and supplied water are regularly tested through laboratory and field systems to protect

communities from water-borne diseases.

- Nukkad Nataks and awareness camps during Piplu Fair, Haroli Utsav and Chintpurni Mahotsav have taken water quality messages to the public.
- Trained women FTK groups are acting as village-level ambassadors of safe drinking water.

### Jal Mahotsav 2026 and Source Sustainability

Jal Mahotsav 2026 was conducted in Una from 8 March to 22 March 2026 with activities across all blocks. The campaign began with Nari Neer Shakti Diwas and included the



National Mega Event, Nadi Diwas, thematic campaigns and World Water Day. Activities promoted community participation, water quality monitoring, source sustainability, O&M; awareness and a culture of water responsibility.

A total of 37 workshops were

conducted across Panchayats in different blocks of District Una. Activities included Jal Arpan Diwas, Jal Bandhan, Jal Sankalp, Jal Vandana, Jal Shringar, Jal Yatra, asset mapping, source mapping, clean-up drives, OHT cleaning, FTK testing and re-orientation of VWSCs, SHGs and Nal Jal Mitras.

Source sustainability has also been promoted through rejuvenation of traditional water bodies such as Dulehar Pond, Pubowal Pond and Gondpur Pond in Haroli Block. Such interventions support local recharge, water conservation and community appreciation of traditional water assets.



Figure :89 | Pubowal Pond rejuvenation: groundwater recharge and source sustainability | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :90 | Gondpur Pond rejuvenation: local water conservation asset | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :91 | Dulehar Pond rejuvenation: traditional water body restored for recharge | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :92 | Nadi Diwas activity: awareness for river conservation and clean water resources | Source: DWSM Una

## Digital Governance and Key Field Responses

Una has initiated digital governance through Sujalam Bharat digital registry, GIS-linked asset monitoring, mobile field audit and promotion of Sujal Gaon App. The district data records 59 Sujalam Bharat IDs

covering 68 schemes, 264 habitations and 47 Sujal Gaon IDs. These systems strengthen asset tracking, supply-hour monitoring, quality status and field response.

The district faces hilly pockets, scattered habitations, long pipeline alignments, low-voltage interruptions, high dependence on pumping,

old distribution networks, leakage-prone stretches and seasonal khad/monsoon damage. Una has responded through practical field measures rather than only planning documents.

## Practical response from

| Field condition                         | Practical response from Una                                                                                                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Hilly pockets and scattered habitations | Retrofitting and augmentation works have extended household tap coverage and improved distribution reliability in dispersed habitations.                               |
| Low voltage and power interruptions     | Pumping stations, pump rooms and machinery are being strengthened, with field coordination for restoration of affected pumping schemes.                                |
| Dependence on pumping schemes           | The district is operating 276 pump rooms, 248 tubewells, 1,210 borewells and associated storage assets to maintain lifted supply.                                      |
| Old pipelines and leakages              | Rising mains and distribution networks have been repaired and strengthened under JJM augmentation to reduce leakage-prone stretches.                                   |
| O&M; and local skill needs              | Nal Jal Mitras/local operators are being trained through ITIs, while PRI/VWSC members and community institutions are trained through CCDU and Jal Mahotsav activities. |
| Floods, khads and monsoon damage        | Source mapping, clean-up drives, OHT/premises cleaning and field-level restoration support have been taken up as part of local preparedness and O&M; action.           |



Figure :93 | Community-led Panchayat activity supporting ownership and participation | Source: DWSM Una



Figure :94 | World Plumber Day/O&M; activity supporting local skill strengthening | Source: DWSM Una

### Una's Sustainability Model in Practice

The Sivasagar sustainability case study shows that rural water supply systems become reliable when governance does not stop after construction. Una is applying these lessons in a Himachal context through Panchayat handover, trained

local operators, women-led FTK groups, laboratory verification, Jal Mahotsav outreach, digital registry and source sustainability works.

Unlike a plan-only approach, the Una model is already visible through field actions: all rural households have been covered with tap connections; water quality testing has reached schools, Anganwadi Centres and

villages; women FTK groups have been trained; distribution systems have been handed over to Gram Panchayats; and source sustainability works have been taken up in local water bodies.

### What Una has put in place

- A large operational water infrastructure base of 235





Figure :95 | Meeting with village community | Source: Longding DWSM

schemes, 276 pump rooms, 620 GSRs and 237 OHTs supporting rural service delivery.

- Universal rural household tap coverage with 1,14,209 rural households covered and 742 villages reported under Har Ghar Jal.

- Water quality assurance through one NABL-accredited district laboratory, two NABL-recognized sub-divisional laboratories and trained FTK women groups.
- Community mobilisation through 37 Jal Mahotsav workshops, Jal Arpan Diwas, Jal Bandhan, Jal Sankalp, Jal Yatra and asset mapping.
- Digital governance through Sujalam Bharat IDs, Sujal Gaon IDs, GIS-linked asset monitoring and mobile field audit systems.
- Recognition of community leaders and Panchayats during Jal Mahotsav, including participation at the National Mega Event.

## Conclusion

Una has achieved the first-generation objective of universal household tap water coverage under Jal Jeevan Mission and is now demonstrating second-generation rural water governance through service delivery, community ownership and quality assurance. The district story is not

limited to assets created; it shows how assets are being operated, monitored, protected and made visible to the community.

The experience of Una shows that safe drinking water is not only an infrastructure outcome; it is a public service that depends on technical competence, trained field teams, administrative convergence and people's participation. When villagers know their sources, respect their water assets, test their water, support O&M; and participate in Gram Sabha processes, Jal Jeevan Mission becomes a sustainable community institution.

- Copy edited by Lopamudra Panda,  
NPMU-NJJM



# Transforming Rural Water Supply: The Jal Jeevan Mission's Success Story in Dras Sector, Kargil, UT Ladakh

– Rakesh Kumar, DC, Kargil, Ladakh



**Rakesh Kumar**

*"Ensuring clean tap water for every household, even in extreme regions like Drass, Ladakh where temperatures drop to minus 50°C, demonstrates inclusive development and dedication to providing basic amenities for all."*

**T**he Jal Jeevan Mission in Kargil UT Ladakh has brought about a historic transformation in rural drinking water supply across Kargil district, demonstrating that even the most difficult geographical and climatic conditions can be overcome through commitment, innovation, and collective effort.

Before the launch of the Mission, only 168 rural households (0.89%) had Functional Household Tap Connections. Today, out of 18,914 rural households, 18,294 households (96.72%) have been provided with Functional Household Tap Connections, including 18,126 households covered since the launch of the Mission. This remarkable achievement reflects the unwavering dedication of our engineers, field functionaries, Village Water &

Sanitation Committees, local administration, and the people of Kargil.

The implementation of the Jal Jeevan Mission in Kargil, particularly in the Drass and Zaskar subdivisions, has been carried out under some of the harshest conditions anywhere in the world. Temperatures often fall below –40°C during winter, causing water pipelines to freeze and limiting construction activities to a short summer working season. The rugged mountainous terrain, remote and scattered habitations, difficult accessibility, and the high cost of transporting construction materials and equipment have made the planning, execution, operation, and maintenance of rural water supply schemes extremely challenging.



Figure :96 | A woman from hilly terrain of Kargil getting water in harsh climatic condition for the first time under Jal Jeevan Mission | Source: PHED Kargil





Figure :97 | Tap installed under JJM bring happiness in local village communities of Kargil villages, living in tough and hilly terrain. | Source: PHED Kargil

The scattered nature of our rural settlements has required the laying of extensive pipeline networks to connect sparsely located households, significantly increasing both project costs and implementation time. Furthermore, Drass, being a cold desert region, has limited water resources and depends largely on glaciers and seasonal snowmelt. The growing impact of climate change and glacier retreat presents an additional challenge to ensuring the long-term sustainability of drinking water sources across the district.

Despite these challenges, the District Water & Sanitation Mission has adopted several climate-resilient and innovative engineering solutions to ensure reliable year-round drinking water supply. Water supply pipelines in Drass and Zaskar have been laid at depths exceeding five feet below ground level to prevent freezing during severe winters. Service reservoirs have been insulated with layers of soil and sand to reduce heat loss and protect stored water from freezing. Winter-resilient infrastruc-

ture, including insulated pipelines and underground reservoirs, has been developed to ensure uninterrupted water supply under sub-zero temperatures. Solar-powered pumping systems have been installed in remote and off-grid villages, while extensive pipeline networks have been constructed to reach scattered and hard-to-access habitations.

One of the most notable innovations is the solarised water tank system developed in Zaskar, which provides 24x7 drinking water even during winters when temperatures fall to  $-30^{\circ}\text{C}$ . Through passive solar heating, thermal insulation, double glazing, an air-lock system, and a black-painted storage tank, this low-cost innovation ensures water remains available throughout the winter season. In addition, a solarised honeycomb polycarbonate shelter with an integrated soak pit system has been introduced for winter water delivery points in Zaskar, preventing water from freezing while keeping the surrounding area dry and

functional. Water quality surveillance has also been significantly strengthened through regular testing and monitoring at the village level to ensure that every household receives safe and potable drinking water.

These climate-resilient interventions have significantly enhanced the reliability and sustainability of rural drinking water supply in one of the coldest inhabited regions of the world. Achieving 96.72% household tap water coverage is a remarkable milestone, but our journey does not end here. Our focus now is on extending Functional Household Tap Connections to the remaining uncovered households, strengthening the operation and maintenance of completed schemes, ensuring long-term source sustainability, enhancing water quality surveillance, and promoting active community ownership through Village Water & Sanitation Committees.

*Copy edited by Amit Ranjan,  
NPMU-NJJM*



Figure :98 | Woman from remote area of Kargil fetching water first time from tap installed under Jal Jeevan Mission | Source: State PHED Team.

As Chairman of the District Water & Sanitation Mission, Kargil, I reaffirm our unwavering commitment to achieving universal household tap water coverage and ensuring that every rural family has access to safe, adequate, reliable, and sustainable drinking water throughout the year. Together, through innovation, resilience, and community participation, we will continue to build a water-secure and healthier future for every village across Kargil district."



## Opinion Article by Secretary, DDWS

A opinion article by Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS), titled *“From Access to Assurance: Reimagining Rural Drinking Water in India,”* was recently published on 19th June, in Devex and lays out the evolving vision of Jal Jeevan Mission as it transitions into its next phase.

The article highlights that India’s rural

drinking water journey under Jal Jeevan Mission is now moving beyond ensuring access to tap connections towards guaranteeing reliable, assured, and sustainable service delivery. It underscores that while significant progress has been made in expanding infrastructure, the next phase under JJM 2.0 must focus on functionality, water quality,

source sustainability, and long-term operation and maintenance through strengthened institutional mechanisms and community ownership.

Read the detailed article <https://www.devex.com/news/from-access-to-assurance-reimagining-rural-drinking-water-in-india-112701>

## DDWS Participated in the 12<sup>th</sup> International Yoga Day

On the occasion of the 12th International Day of Yoga, a programme centred on the theme ‘Yoga for Healthy Ageing’ was organised by the Department of Water Resources, River Development & Ganga Rejuvenation (DoWR, RD&GR), Ministry of Jal Shakti, at Hauz Khas District Park, New Delhi, in which the Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS) participated.

Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Secretary, DDWS, along with senior officials of the Department, took part in a guided yoga session conducted in a step-by-step manner. Senior officers from Jal Jeevan Mission and Swachh Bharat Mission (Gramin) were also present and actively participated in the session.

Subsequently, under the ‘Ek Ped Maa Ke Naam’ campaign, officials

participated in a plantation drive and encouraged others to join the initiative. The programme highlighted that yoga provides a strong foundation for staying healthy and active across all stages of life, while emphasising the critical role of access to safe drinking water and sanitation in supporting overall health and well-being.



Figure :99 | Guided Yoga session on 12<sup>th</sup> International Yoga Day | Source:NJJM

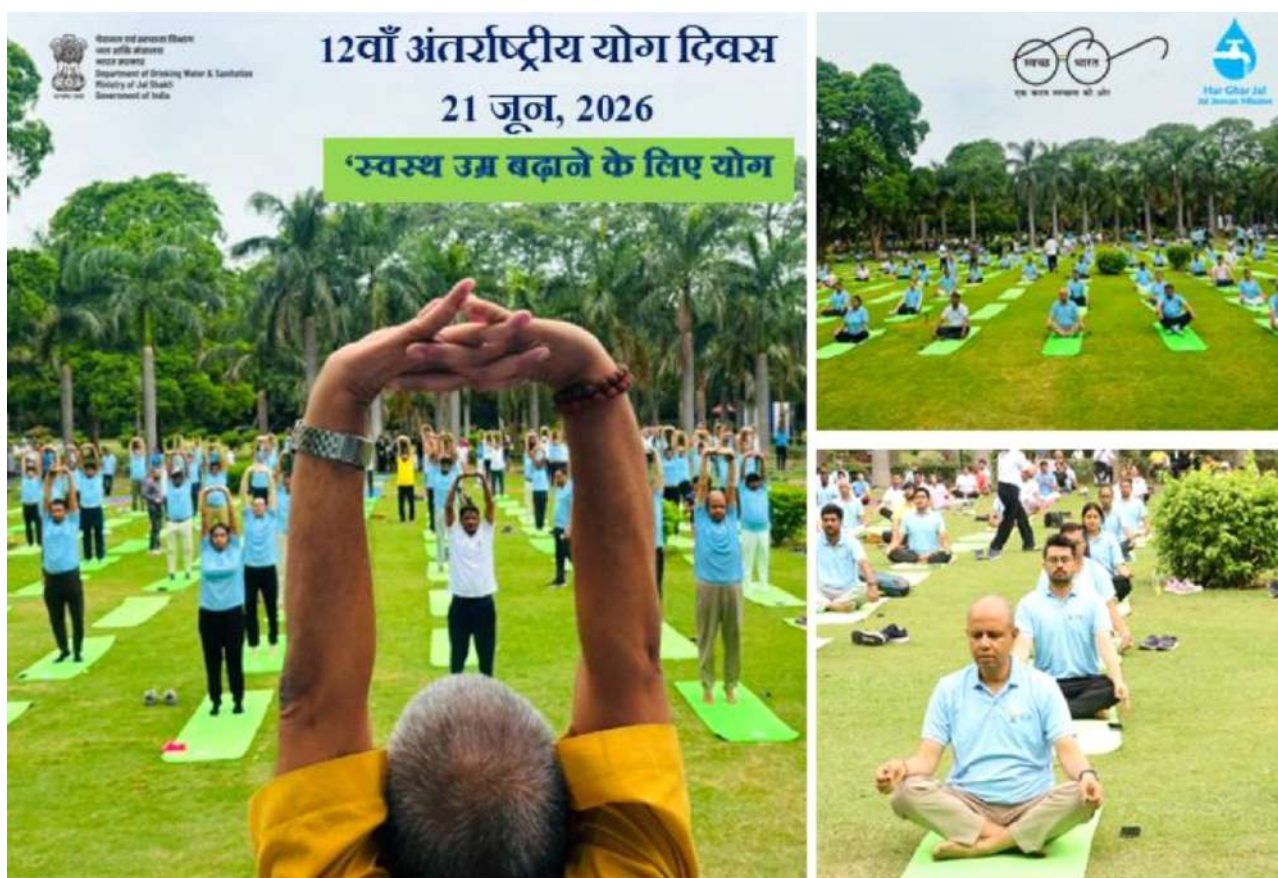


Figure :99 | Guided Yoga session on 12<sup>th</sup> International Yoga Day | Source:NJJM

## DDWS and UNICEF Discuss Future Collaboration in Rural WASH Sector

During a meeting held on 29<sup>th</sup> June 2026, Shri Ashok K. K. Meena, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), met with Ms. Cynthia McCaffrey, UNICEF Representative to India, and her team to discuss opportunities for strengthening collaboration in the rural Water, Sanitation and Hygiene (WASH) sector.

The discussions focused on aligning UNICEF's forthcoming Country Programme (2028–2032) with the priorities of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0 and Swachh Bharat Mission (Grameen), particularly in areas related to improved service delivery,



Figure :100 | Discussion between Secretary, DDWS and UNICEF representative to India | Source:NJJM





Figure :101 | DDWS and UNICEF representative | Source: NJJM

digital transparency, community ownership and the long-term sustainability of water and sanitation systems. Both sides exchanged views on advancing key initiatives such as Sujalam Bharat, community-led approaches including Jal Arpan and Jan Bhagidari, source sustainability measures, and strengthening water quality monitoring and sanitation outcomes in rural areas.

The meeting provided an opportunity to explore areas of convergence that can further support community-driven and accountable service delivery mechanisms. DDWS and UNICEF reaffirmed their shared commitment to promoting sustainable, inclusive and resilient WASH services, with a continued focus on improving the quality of life in rural communities across the country.



## Monthly review meeting



Figure :102 | Opening remark by Secretary, DDWS | Source: NJJM

**T**he monthly review meeting under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) 2.0 was held on 9th June 2026, chaired by Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS), with participation from States/UTs and senior officials of the National Jal Jeevan Mission (NJJM). The meeting reviewed progress, review implementation challenges, and outline priority actions for the coming period.

In his opening remarks, Secretary, DDWS emphasized that the monthly review provides an opportunity to collectively assess achievements, identify gaps, and plan targeted interventions for accelerating implementation. He outlined a set of

four critical priority areas that would define the next phase of Mission execution.

The **first priority** focused on **expediting reform-linked Memoranda of Understanding (MoUs) and finalizing Comprehensive Implementation and Reform Plans (CIRPs)**. He informed that MoUs have already been signed with 25 States, while the remaining are at advanced stages and must be completed promptly. He stressed that CIRPs will serve as the core strategic roadmap for implementing structural reforms, including source sustainability, groundwater management, water quality monitoring, institutional strengthening, and improved service delivery. While one-to-one consultations have been

completed with 18 States, all States/UTs were directed to finalize their CIRPs within the month to ensure nationwide alignment by the end of June.

The **second priority** highlighted was the need to **complete near-finished schemes and translate progress into visible outcomes on the ground**. The Secretary noted that a large number of schemes have already crossed 75% physical progress and can be operationalised quickly. States were urged to prioritise completion of such “low-hanging fruit” projects, ensuring they move beyond construction to full functionality. This includes mandatory 15-day trial runs, commissioning, certification, formal handover to Gram Panchayats, and



transfer of technical documentation. Emphasis was also placed on organising community-led Jan Arpan ceremonies at the village level with participation of public representatives, to reinforce ownership and enhance public visibility of the Mission.

The **third key focus area** was **functionality assessment through self-certification**. The Secretary noted with satisfaction that over one lakh Gram Panchayats have already completed functionality self-certification of drinking water systems. He outlined the next step of consolidating this data into district-level and state-level self-assessed functionality reports, to be prepared by District Water and Sanitation Missions (DWSMs) and State Water and Sanitation Missions (SWSMs), respectively.

Clear timelines were defined for submission of district reports within 15 days, state reports within a week thereafter, and national consolidation within three weeks. He emphasised that these reports would reflect

States' own validated assessment of service delivery and therefore require active ownership and accuracy.

The **fourth priority** was **strengthening fund flow mechanisms to ensure timely financial support for implementation**. Two major mechanisms were highlighted. Under the reimbursement mechanism, States were encouraged to submit claims for expenditure already incurred, noting that approximately ₹2,000 crore has been released so far. The second mechanism, the Financial Management System (FMS), including Single Nodal Account (SNA)-based payments is being operationalised to streamline fund flow, particularly for single-village schemes, and enable timely payments to vendors and contractors. States were directed to ensure that both systems become fully functional by 30th June, with at least one successful transaction completed to familiarise all stakeholders.

Reinforcing these priorities, the Secretary reiterated that the coming month is critical for accelerating

Mission outcomes. He called upon States to ensure timely MoU completion, CIRP finalisation, fast-tracking of schemes nearing completion, robust functionality reporting, and operationalisation of financial systems, thereby strengthening service delivery and ensuring sustainable outcomes.

Further, Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary & Mission Director, NJJM, reviewed overall Mission progress and reiterated the importance of expediting pending MoUs, strengthening Operation & Maintenance (O&M) policies for long-term sustainability, and establishment and orientation of District Technical Units (DTUs) to enhance technical capacity at the district level.

A detailed State/ UT-wise presentation was made by Smt. Swati Meena Naik, Joint Secretary (Water), NJJM, highlighting the progress status, key gaps, and priority areas across States/ UTs, thereby facilitating focused discussions and targeted interventions during the review.



Figure : 103 | Address by AS&MD, NJJM | Source: NJJM

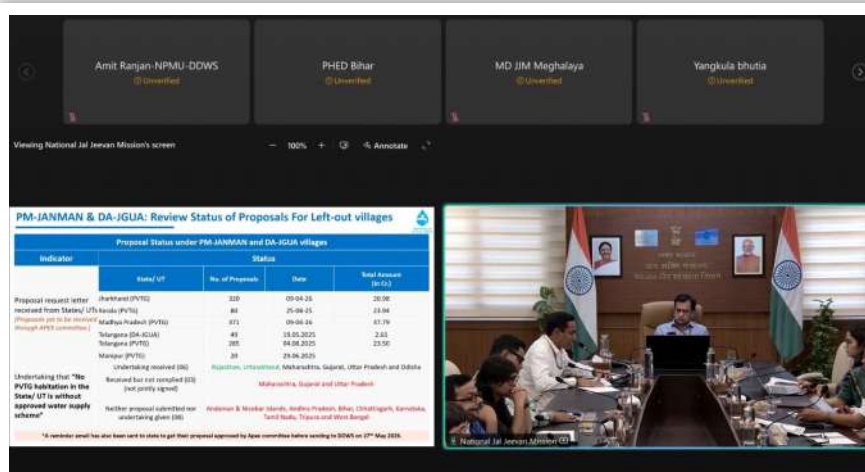


Figure :104 | State/ UT wise presentation on thematic areas | Source: NJJM



Figure :105 | Address by Secretary, DDWS | Source: NJJM

The presentation shows progress on key thematic areas, including O&M policy formulation, Jal Seva Aankalan, SNA-SPARSH payments, Sujal Gaon ID creation, geo-tagging of assets, conduct of DWSM meetings, utilisation of 16th Finance Commission grants, PM JANMAN and DA-JGUA initiatives, groundwater sustainability frameworks, and decision support systems. Each thematic area was reviewed State/UT wise thoroughly.

In view of the upcoming Stop Diarrhoea Campaign, States were specifically advised to intensify water quality testing at both source and household levels, ensuring access to safe and potable drinking water.

The meeting witnessed participation from senior officials of States/UTs and their teams. From NJJM, Joint Secretaries, Directors, Deputy Secretaries, and other officials, along with the NPMU team, actively contributed to the discussions, reaffirming a collective commitment to strengthening implementation under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0.



## Visit of Shri C.R. Patil, Minister of Jal Shakti to West Bengal



Figure :106 | CM, West Bengal welcoming MoJS in his office | Source – X handle of MoJS

Shri C.R. Patil, Union Minister of Jal Shakti visited West Bengal on 18th June 2026. During his visit he held a high-level review meeting with the Chief Minister of West Bengal, Shri Suvendu Adhikari in Kolkata, to review the progress of key water sector programmes being implemented in the State, including Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM), Namami Gange, and various initiatives related to water conservation and water security. The meeting focused on assessing the status of ongoing projects, identifying measures for accelerating implementation, and strengthening cooperation between the Centre and the State for achieving water security and service delivery goals. The Hon'ble Minister was accompanied by Shri Ashok K.K. Meena, Secretary, Department of

Drinking Water & Sanitation (DDWS), and Dr. Ankita Chakravarty, Deputy Secretary, National Jal Jeevan Mission (NJJM) for the review.

During the interaction, Shri C.R. Patil reiterated that under the leadership of Prime Minister Shri Narendra Modi, the Government of India remains committed to supporting States in ensuring effective and time-bound implementation of flagship programmes. He emphasised that the benefits of initiatives related to drinking water, sanitation and water security should reach citizens at the earliest and called for continued collaboration between the Centre and the State Government to achieve the shared objective of providing safe drinking water to every rural household in West Bengal. A detailed presentation was made on the

implementation status of JJM in West Bengal, covering rural household tap water connectivity, progress of ongoing water supply schemes, water quality surveillance, source sustainability interventions, institutional arrangements and key performance indicators. The progress of projects under Namami Gange and various water conservation initiatives was also reviewed. Discussions centred on accelerating delivery of benefits to rural households, strengthening implementation mechanisms and ensuring sustainable management of water resources in the State.

Reviewing the State's performance under JJM, it was noted that West Bengal has made significant progress since the launch of the Mission in August 2019, increasing rural tap



Figure :107 | Interaction of MoJS with CM, west Bengal about JJM Namami Gange and other initiatives | Source – X handle of MoJS

water coverage from around 1% to 56%, with about 97.5 lakh rural households receiving tap water connections. At the same time, nearly 75 lakh rural households remain to be covered, highlighting the need for sustained efforts during the implementation period of JJM 2.0.

The discussions were held in the context of the recently approved JJM 2.0, under which the Union Cabinet has extended the Mission up to December 2028 with an enhanced national outlay. The signing of the JJM 2.0 MoU between the Government of India and the State on 18 May 2026 was noted as an important step towards accelerating implementation, strengthening institutional

mechanisms and improving long-term service delivery outcomes.

During the review, Secretary, DDWS highlighted a number of priority areas requiring focused attention. Emphasis was laid on the early finalisation of the State's Comprehensive Implementation and Reform Plan (CIRP) to facilitate prioritisation of works, reform implementation, monitoring and allocation of resources under JJM 2.0. The need for focused efforts to cover the remaining rural households, strengthen implementation arrangements at the district level and ensure timely completion of ongoing schemes was also discussed.

Secretary, DDWS further stressed the

importance of operationalising reforms envisaged under JJM 2.0, including notification of the Operation & Maintenance Policy, early formation of District Technical Units (DTUs), and greater participation of district administrations in national review mechanisms. The State was also requested to expedite the remaining stages of Jal Seva Aankalan, strengthen efforts towards Har Ghar Jal certification, and accord special attention to coverage of schools and Anganwadi centres, which play a vital role in improving health and nutrition outcomes for children.

Issues relating to financial management and monitoring were also



Figure :108 | Secretary, DDWS reiterating on various aspects under JJM 2.0 | Source – X handle of MoJS



deliberated upon. The progress made by the State in onboarding schemes on the SNA platform and completing API integration and User Acceptance Testing was appreciated, while discussions were held on early operationalisation of production-level data exchange through the SNA–SPARSH framework to enhance transparency, accountability and real-time monitoring. Clarification on identified discrepancies in project-related financial reporting and progress on pending initiatives was also sought.

The progress of projects under Namami Gange and other

water conservation initiatives was reviewed, with discussions focusing on river rejuvenation, water quality improvement, sustainable management of water resources and measures aimed at strengthening long-term water security in the State.

The visit provided an important opportunity to review the progress of ongoing interventions, address implementation challenges and identify measures to accelerate outcomes under Jal Jeevan Mission and other key water sector programmes in the State.

## Visit of Secretary, DDWS to Odisha

Shri Ashok K. K. Meena, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti, visited Odisha on 25 June 2026 to review the progress of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) and Swachh Bharat Mission–Gramin (SBM-G) in the State.

During the review meeting, he appreciated the significant progress achieved by Odisha under Jal Jeevan Mission and noted that the State's efforts are aligned with the objectives of the National Jal Jeevan Mission. He also reviewed the implementation of SBM-G and emphasized the need for sustained efforts towards achieving ODF Plus Model status across Gram Panchayats.

Emphasizing the long-term sustainability of rural water supply systems, Shri Meena stressed the need to strengthen community ownership and institutional mechanisms. He urged the State to empower Gram Panchayats for effective O&M of water supply systems and expedite the transfer of water supply assets to Gram Panchayats and Village Water & Sanitation Committees (VWSCs) under the Jal Arpan initiative, in accordance with NJJM guidelines.



Figure :109 | Secretary DDWS reviewing JJM & SBM -G works during visit | Source – RWSS, Odisha



Figure :110 | Secretary DDWS reviewing JJM & SBM -G works during visit | Source – RWSS, Odisha

Shri Ashok K. K. Meena, Secretary, Department of Drinking Water and Sanitation (DDWS), Ministry of Jal Shakti, visited Odisha on 25 June 2026 to review the progress of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) and Swachh Bharat Mission–Grameen (SBM-G) in the State.

During the review meeting, he appreciated the significant progress achieved by Odisha under Jal Jeevan Mission and noted that the State's efforts are aligned with the objectives of the National Jal Jeevan Mission. He also reviewed the implementation of SBM-G and emphasized the need for sustained efforts towards achieving ODF Plus Model status across Gram Panchayats.

Emphasizing the long-term sustainability of rural water supply systems, Shri Meena stressed the need to strengthen community ownership and institutional mechanisms. He urged the State to empower Gram Panchayats for effective O&M of water supply systems and expedite the transfer of water supply assets to Gram Panchayats and Village Water & Sanitation Committees (VWSCs)



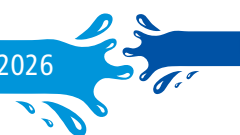
Figure :111 | Interaction with stakeholders by Secretary DDWS during visit | Source – RWSS, Odisha

under the Jal Arpan initiative, in accordance with NJJM guidelines.

The Secretary further advised the State to focus on:

- ◆ Empowering Gram Panchayats for long-term operation and maintenance of water supply systems;
- ◆ Expediting handover of water supply assets to Gram Panchayats and VWSCs through Jal Arpan; and
- ◆ Prioritizing SBM-G assets and accelerating progress towards ODF Plus Model status.

The review meeting was attended by Shri S.N. Girish, Secretary, Panchayati Raj & Drinking Water Department, Government of Odisha; Shri Vineet Bharadwaj,



## Visit of AS&MD, NJJM to Chhattisgarh

Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary & Mission Director, National Jal Jeevan Mission (NJJM), undertook a field visit to Chhattisgarh on 12 June 2026, in line with the Government's continued focus on strengthening last-mile service delivery and ensuring sustainable outcomes under Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM). The visit covered key locations in Raipur district (Abhanpur Block, Village Khatti) and Dhamtari district (Gangrel, Village Maradeo), aimed at reviewing progress, engaging with communities, and reinforcing implementation priorities under JJM 2.0.

At Village Khatti, Shri Soan inspected the Overhead Tank (OHT) and participated in the 'Jal Vandan' ceremony, along with the poojan of Functional Household Tap Connections (FHTCs). He interacted closely with the Sarpanch and villagers to assess the status of water supply, service delivery mechanisms, and water quality management. Women beneficiaries and Jal Bahinis shared their experiences, highlighting tangible improvements in ease of living, health, and time savings due to the availability of household tap connections.

At Village Maradeo in Dhamtari district, Shri Soan attended the "Jal Arpan" and water pledge programme, which brought together representatives and residents from several Gram Panchayats including Maradeo, Siyadehi, Dokal, Parastarai, Darba, Karga, Kotgaon, Ranwa, and Dhruvgram. Through direct interaction with Sarpanches, farmers, and community members, he reviewed drinking water access and emphasised the critical importance of



Figure :112 | AS&MD, NJJM attended Jal Arpan Diwas and interacted with stakeholders during field visit | Source - NJJM



Figure :113 | AS&MD, NJJM reviewing works on various parameters of JJM during field visit | Source - NJJM

rainwater harvesting, source sustainability, and regular water quality testing. A departmental review meeting was also held at Gangrel, attended by Shri Avinash Mishra, Collector, Dhamtari, along with senior officials from the State Mission and PHED, including Shri Onkeshwar Chandravanshi and Shri Sameer Gaur.

On the same day, Shri Soan chaired a state-wide virtual review meeting from Raipur with PHED divisions and district officials to accelerate JJM implementation.

Key focus areas included prioritisation of tribal and remote areas, saturation of left-out households under PM JANMAN and DAJGUA, onboarding of schemes

through SNA SPARSH, and timely completion of projects with strong monitoring. He directed officials to adopt a time-bound, accountable approach to ensure no household is left behind in accessing safe drinking water.

Notably, Shri Soan had also recently visited villages across the Bastar region, reinforcing NJJM's commitment to field-driven governance and outcome-based implementation. The visit underscores a coordinated, mission-mode effort by the Centre and State to achieve saturation under Har Ghar Jal and ensure sustainable, equitable water access for all.

## Visit of AS&MD, NJJM to Uttar Pradesh & Madhya Pradesh



Figure :114 | Jal Arpan Diwas at village Luhari in Bangra Block, Jhansi, UP | Source: NJJM

Shri Kamal Kishore Soan, Additional Secretary & Mission Director, National Jal Jeevan Mission (NJJM), undertook a three-day field visit from 26–28 June 2026 across Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh to review the implementation of Jal Jeevan Mission (JJM) on the ground and assess the preparedness for the next phase of service-oriented rural water supply management under JJM 2.0. Accompanied by Shri Yogendra Kumar Singh, Director, NJJM, the visit covered



Figure :115 | Address by AS&MD, NJJM in Jal Arpan, Jhansi | Source - NJJM





districts of Jhansi and Mahoba in Uttar Pradesh and Niwari and Chhatarpur in Madhya Pradesh.

The visit combined field inspections, review meetings, participation in Jal Arpan Diwas programmes, and extensive interactions with communities, Panchayati Raj Institutions, Water Committees, and district administrations. The focus remained on ensuring sustainable service delivery, water quality management, source sustainability, community ownership, and strengthening Operation & Maintenance (O&M) systems for long-term functionality of rural water supply schemes.



Figure :116 | Central officials visiting water supply asset site, Jhansi | Source - NJJM



Figure :117 | AS&MD, NJJM drinking water from tap under JJM, proving quality of water issued | Source - NJJM



Figure :118 | AS&MD, NJJM taking review at Jhansi Circuit house | Source - NJJM



## Jhansi, Uttar Pradesh: Celebrating Community Ownership

The visit commenced in Jhansi district on 26 June 2026, where Shri Soan participated in the Jal Arpan Diwas programme organised at village Luhari in Bangra Block. The event marked the formal handing over of the village water supply system to the community, symbolising the transition from infrastructure creation to community-led management.

The programme was attended by Dr. Rashmi Arya, Hon'ble MLA, Mauranipur Assembly Constituency, along with officials from NJJM, State Water and Sanitation Mission (SWSM), Uttar Pradesh Jal Nigam (Rural), district administration, and local representatives.

During the programme, villagers expressed their commitment to managing and safeguarding the drinking water assets created under JJM. Speaking on the occasion, Gram Pradhan highlighted how access to household tap water had reduced the burden of fetching water and created opportunities for improved education, livelihoods, and agricultural activities.

Shri Soan and the accompanying officials inspected the Overhead Tank (OHT) complex and reviewed water supply arrangements in the village. The team assessed the adequacy of water distribution systems, regularity of supply, and arrangements for operation and maintenance, emphasising that every rural household should receive uninterrupted access to safe drinking water. Shri Soan directly drank water from a household tap to establish faith on the quality of water supplied under the Mission.

As part of the Jal Arpan ceremony, dignitaries affixed the Jal Arpan symbol at the water infrastructure site and collectively took a pledge for



Figure :119 | Jal Arpan Diwas at Village Jugyai in Niwari district , MP | Source: NJJM



Figure :120 | Jal walk at Village Jugyai in Niwari district , MP | Source: NJJM



Figure :121 | PRA activity at Village Jugyai in Niwari district , MP | Source: NJJM





water conservation, source protection, and sustainable water management. The event reflected the growing emphasis on community participation and local stewardship under Jal Jeevan Mission 2.0.

Earlier in the day, Shri Soan chaired a review meeting at the Jhansi Circuit House to assess the progress of JJM works in the district. Discussions focused on project implementation, quality of works, restoration of roads affected during pipeline laying, and timely completion of pending activities. He directed officials to ensure that restoration works are carried out in a time-bound and quality-conscious manner to minimise inconvenience to citizens.

## Mahoba, Uttar Pradesh: Delivering the Promise of Har Ghar Jal

The next phase of the visit took Shri Soan to Mahoba district in Uttar Pradesh, where he attended a Jal Arpan Samaroh at village Shivhar. The event celebrated the successful delivery of functional household tap connections under Jal Jeevan Mission and showcased the transformation underway in Bundelkhand through assured access to safe drinking water. Community members, local representatives, district officials, and State Mission functionaries participated in the programme and renewed their commitment towards water conservation and sustainable service delivery.

Addressing the gathering, Shri Soan noted that for decades, water scarcity had been one of the defining challenges of Bundelkhand. He observed that a few years ago, it was difficult to imagine that treated water from rivers, dams, and other reliable sources could reach every rural household across the region. Today, through Jal Jeevan Mission, that vision is steadily becoming a reality.



Figure :122 | AS&MD, NJJM chairing review meeting at Niwari district , MP | Source - NJJM



Figure :123 | Jal Arpan Diwas at Village Shivhar, Mahoba district , MP | Source - NJJM



Figure :124 | Jal Bandhan being done by AS&MD, NJJM at Village Shivhar, Mahoba district , MP | Source - NJJM



He underlined that safe drinking water is not merely a public utility but a foundation for healthier, stronger, and more self-reliant rural communities. He also interacted with the media and community members, highlighting the mission's achievements and the importance of sustaining these gains through effective O&M systems and community participation.

During the ceremony, certificates of appreciation were presented to members of Water Committees and community volunteers who had contributed significantly towards implementation and successful operation of village water supply systems. Villagers shared how access to tap water had eliminated the need to travel long distances for drinking water, allowing households to devote more time to education, livelihood activities, and productive pursuits.

Shri Soan also held discussions with district officials on key reform-oriented aspects of JJM 2.0, including sustainable service delivery models, institutional strengthening, and long-term functionality of water supply systems.

## Chhatarpur, Madhya Pradesh: Focusing on Long-Term Service Delivery

The final leg of the visit covered Chhatarpur district in Madhya Pradesh, where Shri Soan chaired a meeting of the District Water and Sanitation Mission (DWSM) attended by senior officials including representatives of Madhya Pradesh Jal Nigam, the district administration, and Panchayati Raj institutions.

Discussions centred on strengthening sustainable O&M systems for Multi-Village Water Supply Schemes (MVWSS), capacity building of Village Water Supply Operators, empowerment of Gram Panchayats, digital grievance redressal mechanisms,



Figure :125 | Jal Arpan Diwas at Village Shivhar, Mahoba district, MP | Source: NJJM



Figure :126 | Jal Bandhan being done by AS&MD, NJJM at Village Shivhar, Mahoba district, MP | Source: NJJM

Panchayat Darpan-based billing and payment systems, and water conservation measures to ensure long-term water security.

Shri Soan also attended the Jal Arpan Diwas programme at village Mailwar, where he was accorded a traditional welcome by the local community. During the village visit, he inspected water supply infrastructure, interacted with villagers and VWSC members, and reviewed community participation mechanisms supporting scheme operation and maintenance.

A PRA-based village map was presented by the community, highlighting local planning efforts and

the role of participatory approaches in strengthening water governance. Several individuals and community members who had played an important role in achieving Har Ghar Jal certification were felicitated for their contribution. Students who excelled in competitions organised as part of awareness activities were also recognised.

The delegation visited the exhibition model of the Bansujara-Badamalhara Multi-Village Water Supply Scheme, where officials provided a detailed overview of the scheme's design, implementation progress, and operational framework. The





Figure :127 | AS&MD, NJJM doing Jal Arpan at village Mailwar, Chhatarpur district, MP | Source - NJJM



Figure :128 | AS&MD, NJJM participated in Jal Walk at village Mailwar, Chhatarpur district, MP | Source - NJJM



Figure :129 | Model of water supply scheme, Chhatarpur district, MP | Source - NJJM



Figure :130 | AS&MD, NJJM taking review at Chhatarpur district, MP | Source - NJJM

programme concluded with cultural performances showcasing the rich heritage of Bundelkhand and emphasising the importance of community engagement in sustaining development initiatives.

The three-day field visit underscored the evolving priorities of Jal Jeevan Mission as it transitions from infrastructure creation towards ensuring reliable, sustainable, and citizen-centric water service delivery.

Across both Uttar Pradesh and Madhya Pradesh, the review highlighted the growing role of Panchayats, Water Committees, and local communities in managing rural water supply systems.

Through participation in Jal Arpan Diwas events, interactions with beneficiaries, site inspections, and extensive review meetings, Shri Kamal Kishore Soan reinforced the importance of community owner-

ship, institutional accountability, water quality assurance, source sustainability, and robust O&M systems. The visit also provided an opportunity to review preparedness for JJM 2.0 and to strengthen the foundations required for delivering safe drinking water services to every rural household, every day, on a sustainable basis.





## Jal Jeevan Mission in Media



### From access to assurance: Reimagining rural drinking water in India

Opinion: An Indian effort to improve access to clean water is making real headway. The secretary of the department of drinking water and sanitation at the government of India details how it plans to take it further.

Shok K. K. Meena // 16 June 2025





Har Ghar Jal  
Jal Jeevan Mission

# Jal Jeevan Samvad



Follow, like and subscribe



Jal Jeevan Mission, India



@jaljeevan\_



Jal Jeevan Mission



@jaljeevanmission



jjm.gov.in



Jal Jeevan Mission

**Government of India**  
**Ministry of Jal Shakti**  
**Department of Drinking Water & Sanitation**  
**National Jal Jeevan Mission**  
New Delhi - 110 003  
e - mail: rnd-ddws@gov.in